



2015 GROUP STAGE OFFICIAL PROGRAMME

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AFC Message



**Shaikh Salman Bin
Ebrahim Al Khalifa**

AFC President



Dear friends,

The 2015 AFC Champions League is upon us and once again we can look forward to a truly fantastic nine months of top quality football.

The AFC Champions League is Asia's most esteemed football club competition and it has built a strong following since its inception. Over the years, the competition has raised the game across the continent by delivering the very best of Asian club football at stadiums and to TV viewers around the globe. Last season's competition was a thrilling contest throughout, and provided fans with lasting memories of great football action.

The AFC Champions League provides an unrivalled stage for Asia's football stars and clubs to showcase their talent. Drive, stamina and skill will be defining factors in this season's competition as clubs, old and new, look to emulate the success of Western Sydney Wanderers who emerged triumphant last year.

Lifting the continent's most prestigious club competition trophy is a great incentive, but the winners of the AFC Champions League will also be Asia's representatives at the FIFA Club World Cup – which is a fantastic privilege.

I would like to wish all the teams the best of luck and a big thank you to the fans, sponsors and the media for your continuous support. The best of success for the new season!

Shaikh Salman Bin Ebrahim Al Khalifa
AFC President

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History

THE QUEST FOR ASIAN GLORY

Western Sydney Wanderers' historic victory over Al Hilal in the final of the 2014 AFC Champions League in November was a true milestone for Australian football. Six teams from Australia had stepped up to the continental challenge without success since A-League sides joined the AFC Champions League in 2007 before the team from Parramatta, in their maiden appearance in the competition, went all the way to lift the prestigious trophy.

Tony Popovic's Western Sydney edged out Al Hilal 1-0 on aggregate, a victory which went one better than predecessors Adelaide United who fell short at the final hurdle after losing to Japan's Gamba Osaka in 2008.

Tomi Juric's 64th minute strike in October's first leg at Parramatta Stadium had given Western Sydney a crucial 1-0 lead to take to the return meeting in Riyadh.

And it proved enough as two-time Asian Club Championship winners Al Hilal failed to convert a dominant performance in front of nearly 64,000 at the King Fahd International Stadium into a breakthrough as Western Sydney held on to become the first A-League side to win the AFC Champions

League title.

"The game was everything you expect from a final. It was difficult. They are a very good team, they had fantastic support, but we are an excellent team and we showed over two legs how good we are," said Western Sydney coach Popovic following the second leg.

"It is still a little surreal for me as a coach. I am sure it will hit home in the next few days when we reflect. For me, I am just proud for these players and our club. The first time in the competition, to win it, I think in the future we will really understand how special this run has been and how it was to win this title."

Western Sydney goalkeeper Ante Covic was named the AFC Champions League MVP after his ninth clean sheet on the continent in the second leg of the final, which was arguably the 39-year-old's best as the goalkeeper made a number of vital saves including a superb one-handed block to deny Al Hilal substitute Yasser Al Qahtani inside the final five minutes.

"It is unbelievable," said Covic. "To come away in the short history of this club and win a title like this is something you carry with you for the rest of your life."

Victory in the AFC Champions League also saw Western Sydney named the AFC's Club Team of the Year, while Popovic won the AFC Coach of the Year accolade.



History



Western Sydney's triumph marked the end of an eight year wait for an Australian club to lift Asia's premier prize after neighbours Sydney FC and Adelaide were the first two sides to participate in the AFC Champions League in 2007.

With only one team from each group qualifying from the knockout stage of that tournament, both sides were eliminated in the group stage, although Sydney were particularly unlucky to miss out on a place in the quarter-finals after being edged out by a point by group winners, and eventual champions, Urawa Red Diamonds from Japan.

Before the A-League sides joined the scene, teams from West Asia had dominated the revamped continental championship after winning three of the first four editions of the new AFC Champions League; a merger of the Asian Club Championship, the Asian Cup Winners' Cup and the Asian Super Cup into a consolidated competition that was inaugurated in 2002. Inaugural winners Al Ain of the United Arab Emirates and Saudi Arabia's Al Ittihad, in both 2004 and 2005, took the first three titles before Korea

Republic's Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors broke the stranglehold, becoming the first winner from the east in 2006.

Urawa swiftly followed a year later when the J.League side claimed the title in front of a bumper crowd at Saitama Stadium after beating Iran's Sepahan. Although the Australian clubs were unable to make a significant impact in their maiden campaign, their second year was far more successful as Adelaide far outstripped countrymen Melbourne Victory by going all the way to the 2008 final, although they fell at the last hurdle after losing 5-0 on aggregate to Gamba.

In 2009, two A-League sides made their debuts in the AFC Champions League as Central Coast Mariners and Newcastle Jets took part in their maiden continental campaigns, and although Central Coast bowed out in the group stage, Newcastle reached the Round of 16 only to be outmatched by eventual winners Pohang Steelers from Korea Republic who defeated Al Ittihad in the final in Tokyo.

And 12 months later it was another Korean team emerging triumphant



from Tokyo as Seongnam Ilhwa Chunma downed Zobahan from Iran while Melbourne, making their second appearance, again failed to progress to the knockout stages. In their third continental campaign, Adelaide were edged out by Jeonbuk following a thrilling Round of 16 tie that could only be decided after extra-time.

The 2011 campaign was a more forgettable one for teams from Australia as for the first time since their maiden tournament neither A-League representative made the knockout stage with both Melbourne and Sydney's Asian adventure ending in the group stage. Instead it was a return to form for the west as Qatar's Al Sadd edged out Jeonbuk on penalties in the final.

The following year's competition, though, brought a return to form with Adelaide's play-off victory over Persipura Jayapura meaning three teams from Australia participated in the AFC Champions League for the first time. And while debutants Brisbane Roar as well as Central Coast were unable to reach the Round of 16, Adelaide topped their group and then edged out Nagoya Grampus of Japan 1-0 to reach the quarter-finals before taking part



in an epic tie with Uzbekistan's Bunyodkor, that the Central Asians would eventually win 5-4 on aggregate.

Bunyodkor, though, would be on the end of a comprehensive 5-1 defeat to Ulsan Hyundai in the semi-final and the K-League side replicated that dominance in the final after beating Saudi Arabia's Al Ahli 3-0 in the tournament showpiece. It was a case of feast to famine in 2013 for the A-League as just one club from Australia made it to the group stage of the AFC Champions League after Brisbane were knocked out of the play-offs by Buriram United of Thailand. Sole representative Central Coast did, however, advance to the Round of 16 for their first appearance in the knockout stages. But Central Coast were confronted by Marcello Lippi's Guangzhou Evergrande and the FIFA World Cup winning-coach would guide his team past the A-League side on the way to China's first continental title in 23 years after defeating Korea's FC Seoul in the final on away goals. Western Sydney joined Melbourne and Central Coast in the 2014 competition, with Popovic's side making their debut in the tournament

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

History



along their more continentally savvy countrymen. But rather than let their inexperience count against them, Western Sydney, who were only formed in 2012, shocked Asia's elite by disposing of J.League champions Sanfrecce Hiroshima, Chinese champions Guangzhou, 2013 finalists FC Seoul and ultimately Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal to lift the trophy. Although this year Western Sydney have struggled domestically, teams will have learnt that you underestimate Popovic's side at your peril, with their solid defence and teamwork proving particularly effective on the continental stage. Guangzhou, meanwhile, have brought in FIFA World Cup-winning captain Fabio Cannavaro as coach, with Brazilians Alan and Ricardo Goulart joining countryman Elkeson at the 2013 champions under the Italian following the departure of Lippi.

Along with Guangzhou, the other sides from the Chinese Super League remain a threat after bringing in expensive talent and playing in front of bumper crowds who create an intimidating atmosphere. From Korea, domestic champions Jeonbuk will be looking to add a second continental

title to their trophy cabinet, while two-time Asian champions Seongnam FC return into the reckoning. Two time Asian Club Championship winners Suwon Samsung and FC Seoul complete the quartet of teams flying the flag for Korea.

Also from the east come a formidable threat in the form of domestic treble winners Gamba who remain the last J.League side to lift the AFC Champions League title with their victory in 2008. Gamba will be joined by 2007 champions Urawa as well as Kashima Antlers and Kashiwa Reysol.

From the west, Al Hilal will seek redemption following their defeat at the final hurdle in last year's championship climax, and they will be accompanied by Saudi league champions Al Nassr and Al Shabab. Although two-time AFC Champions League winners Al Ittihad have missed out this year, cross-Jeddah rivals Al Ahli ensure the port city is represented.

Inaugural AFC Champions League winners Al Ain, who reached the semi-finals last year, return in an attempt to add to their 2003 success and boast last year's top scorer in the form of Ghana striker Asamoah Gyan as well as

History



one of the stars of the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 in playmaker Omar Abdulrahman.

Fellow Emirati side Al Ahli, who claimed their sixth league title and first since 2009 in 2014 after finishing the season 16 points clear of Al Wahda, will look to convert strong domestic form after also winning the League Cup, into a run on the continental stage after failing to progress beyond the group stage in their four previous appearances.

Foolad Khuzestan went undefeated in last year's tournament but bowed out on away goals in the Round of 16 and the Iranian champions will be looking to go even further in the tournament. Tehran's Esteghlal failed to qualify for this year's AFC Champions League, but rivals Persepolis, who finished just two points behind Foolad in last season's race for the championship, ensure another date at the cauldron of noise that is the Azadi Stadium, with Naft Tehran and Tractorsazi Tabriz rounding out the representatives from the Iran Pro League.

Lekhwiya secured their fourth consecutive appearance in the AFC

Champions League when they were crowned Qatar Stars League champions for a third time in four seasons in 2014 and they are joined in the group stage by former continental champion's Al Sadd.

Al Sadd earned a spot in the AFC Champions League qualifiers with a 3-0 win over Al Sailiya in the 2014 Emir Cup final and then the 2011 champions secured their 10th appearance in the group stages after consecutive penalty shoot-out victories over Al Riffa of Bahrain and then Al Wahda of the United Arab Emirates in the play-offs.

Twice crowned champions of Asia following their victories in the Asian Club Championship in 1989 and the AFC Champions League in 2011, the Doha club suffered a pair of heavy defeats during last year's tournament but reached the quarter-finals before bowing out to eventual finalists Al Hilal of Saudi Arabia after losing 1-0 on aggregate.

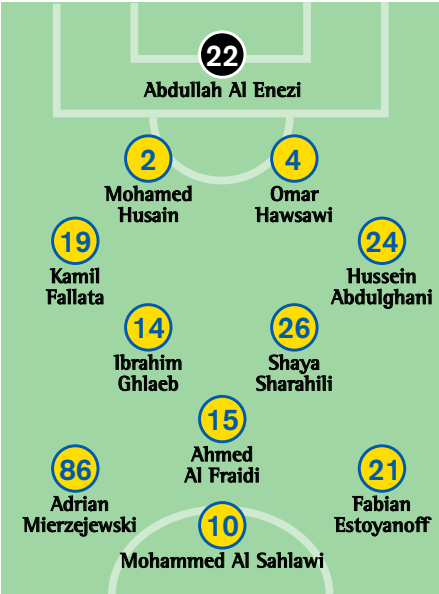
Once again a continent waits with baited breath for another exciting chapter to be added to the prestigious history of Asian football as the hunt for the most illustrious title in the continental game begins.

2006

GROUP A

Al Nassr

Saudi Arabia



Line-Up



Qualified as: Saudi League – Winner • Founded: 1955
Ground: King Fahd International Stadium, Riyadh (67,000)
Saudi League (7): 2014, 1995, 1994, 1989, 1981, 1980, 1976
AFC Champions League: Round of 16 2011
Asian Club Championship: Runner-up 1995
Asian Cup Winners’ Cup (1): 1998; Runner-up 1992
Asian Super Cup (1): 1998

Overview

With previous pedigree in continental competition, Al Nassr will make just their second appearance in the AFC Champions League in 2015 after being crowned Saudi League champions for the seventh time. In 2014 having finished the season two points ahead of cross-city rivals Al Hilal. In their first AFC Champions League campaign in 2011, Al Nassr progressed beyond the group stage behind eventual champions Al Sadd, but were eliminated by Iran’s Zobahan after suffering a 4-1 defeat in their Round of 16 tie. Runner-up in the Asian Club Championship in 1995, Al Nassr also claimed both the Asian Cup Winners’ Cup and Asian Super Cup in 1998.

Key Players

Mohammed Al Sahlawi scored 17 goals at an average of just over a goal a game as Al Nassr won the Saudi League last year. And although Saudi Arabia were eliminated in the group stage of the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015, Al Sahlawi netted three times after finding the net twice against DPR Korea and also against Uzbekistan. An ever-present in the backline for Al Nassr, Saudi Arabia centre-back Omar Hawsawi was a fixture in the side that took part in the 2011 AFC Champions League and started all three games for his national team at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015. Poland international Adrian Mierzejewski was signed ahead of the 2014 season and the former Trabzonspor midfielder has already become an important member of the Al Nassr side as well as a significant goal threat.

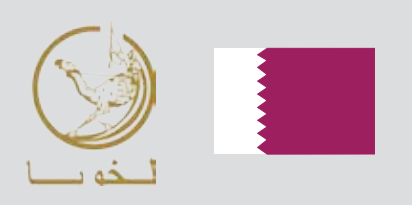
Coach: Jorge Da Silva

Former Uruguay international forward Jorge Da Silva joined Al Nassr for the first time in 2009 and led the side to a third place finish in the league and the quarter-finals of the Crown Prince Cup. And after a spell in the United Arab Emirates, the 53-year-old returned to Al Nassr in November 2014 for a second stint at the club. Previously, the former Spanish league top scorer led both Defensor Sporting and Penarol to win domestic titles in Uruguay.

GROUP A

Lekhwiya

Qatar



Line-Up



Qualified as: Qatar Stars League – Winner • Founded: 1938
Ground: Abdulla Bin Khalifa Stadium, Doha (10,000)
Qatar Stars League (3): 2014, 2012, 2011
AFC Champions League: Quarter-Finals 2013; Group Stage 2014, 2012

Overview

Originally founded in 1938 as Al Shorta, Lekhwiya secured their fourth consecutive appearance in the AFC Champions League when they were crowned Qatar Stars League champions for a third time in four seasons in 2014. Lekhwiya won back-to-back domestic titles in 2011 and 2012 and also finished runners-up in 2013. A group stage elimination in 2014 after a successful route through the play-offs saw the Qatari side unable to build on their best-ever performance in the AFC Champions League during the previous year when Lekhwiya reached the knockout stage for the first time. They beat Saudi Arabia’s Al Hilal in the Round of 16 only to lose to eventual champions Guangzhou Evergrande in the quarter-finals.

Key Players

Spaniard Chico Flores reunited with former Swansea City manager Michael Laudrup in August 2014 and the central defender, who played for Mallorca, Genoa and Almeria, brings solidity and experience to the backline. Qatar forward Ismail Mohamad has been a part of his country’s most successful period in recent times after winning the 2014 WAFF Championship and 2014 Gulf Cup titles. Versatile midfielder Nam Tae-hee played an important role in Korea Republic’s runner-up finish at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 and made four appearances including the final while also scoring the only goal in the win over Kuwait in the group stage. Nam, who also helped Korea win a bronze medal at the 2012 Olympic Games, was Lekhwiya’s joint top scorer during the 2013/2014 season with 12 goals.

Coach: Michael Laudrup

One of the icons of Danish football, Michael Laudrup made a name for himself as a player after winning league titles with Ajax, Barcelona, Real Madrid and Juventus. After hanging his boots up Laudrup had huge success as a coach with Brondby where he won the Danish Superliga and the Danish Cup and he was named the Danish Manager of the Year on two occasions. He had several coaching stints in Russia, Spain and Wales with Swansea City before joining Lekhwiya in June 2014.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Abdullah Al Shammari	24/11/1991
2	DF	Mohamed Husain	31/07/1980
3	DF	Abdullah Madu	15/07/1993
4	DF	Omar Hawsawi	27/09/1985
5	DF	Jamaan Al Dawsari	19/06/1987
8	MF	Yahya Al Shehri	26/06/1990
10	FW	Mohammed Al Sahlawi	10/01/1987
12	DF	Khaled Al Ghamdi	28/03/1988
13	DF	Mohammed Eid	03/05/1987
14	MF	Ibrahim Ghaleb	28/09/1990
15	MF	Ahmed Al Fraid	29/01/1988
16	MF	Abdulaziz Al Jebreen	13/04/1990
18	FW	Armando Wila	12/05/1985
19	DF	Kamil Fallata	31/03/1983
20	DF	Ibrahim Al Zubaidi	04/10/1989
21	MF	Fabian Estoyanoff	27/09/1982
22	GK	Abdullah Al Enezi	20/09/1990
23	MF	Saud Hassan	17/08/1989
24	DF	Hussain Abdulghani	21/01/1977
25	MF	Khaled Al Zaylai	16/03/1987
26	MF	Shaya Sharahili	30/05/1990
27	MF	Awadh Khamis Al Faraj	15/07/1988
29	MF	Musab Al Otaibi	03/03/1992
32	GK	Hussain Shaian	23/05/1989
37	MF	Ayman Abdullah	27/12/1994
44	MF	Ali Al Khaibari	09/07/1989
86	MF	Adrian Mierzejewski	06/11/1986
99	FW	Hassan Al Raheb	21/08/1983

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Mohammed Al Bakari	28/03/1997
2	DF	Mohamed Musa	01/01/1986
3	DF	Ahmed Yasser	17/05/1994
4	DF	Chico Flores	06/03/1987
5	FW	Muhammad Razaq	04/04/1986
6	DF	Dame Traore	15/05/1986
7	DF	Khaled Muftah	02/07/1992
8	MF	Luiz Junior	13/01/1989
9	MF	Abdulrahman Mohammed	16/03/1988
10	MF	Nam Tae-hee	03/07/1991
11	MF	Talal Al Qahtani	15/12/1987
12	MF	Karim Boudiaf	16/09/1990
13	FW	Mohammed Salah	15/04/1996
14	DF	Mohammed Tresor	04/08/1987
15	MF	Osama Al Safady	12/02/1996
16	FW	Abdelhadi Salah	01/01/1995
19	DF	Ahmed Yasser	17/05/1994
20	FW	Ali Afif	20/01/1988
23	FW	Sebastian Soria	08/11/1983
24	DF	Khaled Radwan	02/10/1990
28	MF	Youssef Msakni	28/10/1990
33	GK	Ahmad Hatami	25/08/1980
40	GK	Amine Lecomte	26/04/1990
70	FW	Ismail Mohamad	05/04/1990
77	MF	Ahmad Al Emadi	19/06/1990
79	MF	Vladimir Weiss	30/11/1989
90	GK	Ivan Rodrigues	05/01/1992

GROUP A

Persepolis

Iran



Qualified as: Iran Pro League – Runner-up • **Founded:** 1963 • **Ground:** Azadi Stadium, Tehran (100,000)

Iran Pro League (9): 2008, 2002, 2000, 1999, 1997, 1996, 1976, 1974, 1972

Hazfi Cup (5): 2011, 2010, 1999, 1991, 1988

AFC Champions League: Round of 16 2012, 2009; Group Stage 2011, 2003

Asian Cup Winners' Cup (1): 1991; Runner-up 1993

Overview

One of Iran’s most popular sides, Persepolis return to the AFC Champions League for the first time since 2012 after finishing runners-up in the Iran Pro league in 2014, just two points behind champions Foolad Khouzeestan. Winners of a record nine Iranian championships, Persepolis won the inaugural Asian Cup Winners’ Cup in 1991 and have progressed to the knockout stage of the AFC Champions League on two occasions in 2009 and 2012. With group stage exits also in 2003 and 2011, last time out in the AFC Champions League, Persepolis progressed from the group stage only to lose to Saudi Arabia’s Al Ittihad in 2012.

Key Players

Named the 2014 Iran Football Federation’s Young Player of the Year, Mohammad Abbaszadeh is continuing to show the form that his debut season in Iran’s top flight promised. Having joined Persepolis in 2013, after he was top scorer in the second tier with Nassaji Mazandaran, striker Abbaszadeh has already established himself as a key member of the squad and key source of goals. Experienced club captain Mohammad Nouri is the veteran presence amongst a youthful side after the midfielder signed from Saba Battery in 2010. Veteran defender Mohsen Bengar helped Sepahan reach the 2007 AFC Champions League final before moving to Tehran and Persepolis in 2012. During his time with Sepahan, former Iran international Bengar won the Iranian league title once and the Hazfi Cup in two occasions.

Coach: Hamid Derakhshan

Former Iran captain Hamid Derakhshan retuned to former club Persepolis as coach in September 2014. Derakhshan spent 12 years as a player with Persepolis before taking over as coach following his retirement in 1994. During his time as a player with Persepolis, Derakhshan won the Asian Cup Winners’ Cup in 1991. He also coached Iran’s U-17 national team and several clubs including Shahin Bushehr who he led to the 2012 Hazfi Cup final.

GROUP A

Bunyodkor

Uzbekistan



Qualified as: Uzbek League – Fourth via play-offs • **Founded:** 2005

Ground: Bunyodkor Stadium, Tashkent (34,000)

Uzbek League (5): 2013, 2011, 2010, 2009, 2008

Uzbek Cup (4): 2013, 2012, 2010, 2008

AFC Champions League: Semi-Finals 2012, 2008; Quarter-Finals 2009; Round of 16 2014, 2013, 2011, 2010

Overview

Winners of the Uzbek League in five of the previous six seasons, Bunyodkor finished a disappointing fourth in 2014 but secured a spot in the group stage of the AFC Champions League for the eighth season in a row after they defeated Al Jazira of the United Arab Emirates in the play-offs. While the Tashkent club have yet to reach an AFC Champions League final, Bunyodkor have a solid record in the continental tournament after making it to the semi-finals in 2008 and 2012 and qualifying for the knockout stage in all seven of their previous appearances. Formed as Kuruvchi in 2005, Bunyodkor rose quickly through the domestic leagues and qualified for the AFC Champions League just three seasons later.

Key Players

Sardor Rashidov was the match-winner against Al Jazira in the play-off for the AFC Champions League following a successful AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 as the striker helped Uzbekistan reach the quarter-finals. Rashidov featured in all four games in Australia having scored 15 goals for Bunyodkor in all competitions in 2014. Vokhid Shodiev is now in his second season with Bunyodkor after joining from Buxoro ahead of the 2014 season. Also a member of the national team, Shodiev was also on target during Bunyodkor’s 2-1 victory over Al Jazira in the play-offs. Well-travelled Japanese midfielder Minori Sato has already ticked off spells with clubs in the United States, Mexico, Latvia and Belarus by the age of 23 and the tricky playmaker is an important creative cog in the Bunyodkor midfield having joined the club in March 2014.

Coach: Sergey Lushchan

Former Uzbekistan international and Bunyodkor player Sergey Lushchan joined the club’s coaching structure after winding up his playing career in 2008. After roles with the youth academy, youth team and reserve side, Lushchan was appointed coach in June 2014 following a month’s spell with the Uzbekistan U-19 team. As a player, Lushchan won the Uzbek League and Cup double in 2008, although as a manager he is still seeking his first silverware after Bunyodkor finished fourth.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Sousha Makani	18/11/1986
2	MF	Omid Alishah	10/01/1992
3	DF	Mohammad Reza Khanzadeh	11/05/1991
4	DF	Michael Umana	16/07/1982
5	DF	Mahdi Jafarpour	20/08/1984
6	DF	Mohsen Bengar	06/07/1979
8	FW	Mehdi Daghighelch	30/01/1990
10	FW	Reza Norozi	21/09/1982
11	MF	Payam Sadeghian	29/02/1992
14	MF	Mohammad Noori	09/01/1983
15	MF	Afshin Esmailzadeh	21/04/1992
16	FW	Reza Khaleghifar	21/09/1983
17	FW	Mehdi Taremi	18/07/1992
18	MF	Mehrdad Kafshgari	02/05/1987
19	MF	Milad Kamandani	07/07/1994
20	DF	Alireza Nourmohammadi	03/07/1981
22	FW	Tadeu	01/04/1986
24	FW	Hadi Norozi	22/06/1985
26	MF	Hamidreza Aliasgari	25/05/1990
28	MF	Ahmad Noorollahi	01/02/1993
30	DF	Mobin Mirdoraghi	19/04/1993
33	FW	Mohammad Abbaszadeh	09/05/1990
41	GK	Morteza Ghadimipour	27/08/1994
44	GK	Masoud Hemami	01/05/1983
66	MF	Fernando Gabriel	11/05/1988
77	FW	Ali Alipour	11/11/1995
99	DF	Babak Hatami	15/08/1986

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Pavel Bugalo	21/08/1974
2	DF	Akmal Shorakhmedov	10/05/1986
4	DF	Hayrulla Karimov	22/04/1978
5	MF	Dilshod Juraev	21/04/1992
6	DF	Anvar Gafurov	14/05/1982
7	MF	Chaker Zouaghi	10/01/1985
8	MF	Jovlon Ibrokhimov	10/12/1990
9	FW	Minori Sato	02/03/1991
10	FW	Anvar Berdiev	11/05/1978
11	FW	Mirzohid Gafurov	22/08/1988
13	DF	Ivan Milosevic	03/11/1984
14	FW	Vokhid Shodiev	09/11/1986
15	DF	Obid Jurabaev	17/02/1986
16	DF	Artyom Filiposyan	06/01/1988
17	DF	Dostonbek Khamdamov	24/07/1996
19	FW	Zabikhillo Urinboev	30/03/1995
20	MF	Samir Bekric	20/10/1984
21	MF	Sardor Rashidov	14/06/1991
24	MF	Nuriddin Khasanov	20/07/1994
25	GK	Murotjon Zukhurov	23/02/1983
27	MF	Sardor Sabirkhodjaev	06/11/1994
28	DF	Dilyorbek Irmatov	30/04/1989
29	MF	Otabek Shukurov	22/06/1996
35	GK	Abdulkarim Mukhamedov	11/01/1994
37	MF	Doston Abdurahmonov	05/05/1990
39	FW	Eldor Shomurodov	29/06/1995
40	MF	Timur Ayupov	28/03/1993
44	MF	Mirjamol Kosimov	24/09/1995
45	GK	Akbar Turaev	27/08/1989
48	DF	Akramjon Komilov	14/03/1996

GROUP B

Pakhtakor

Uzbekistan



GROUP B

Al Shabab

Saudi Arabia



Qualified as: Uzbek League – Winner • **Founded:** 1956 • **Ground:** Pakhtakor Stadium, Tashkent (35,000)
Uzbek League (10): 2014, 2012, 2007, 2006, 2005, 2004, 2003, 2002, 1998, 1992
Uzbek Cup (11): 2011, 2009, 2007, 2006, 2005, 2004, 2003, 2002, 2001, 1997, 1993
AFC Champions League: Semi-Finals 2004, 2003; Quarter-Finals 2009; Round of 16 2010; Group Stage 2013, 2012, 2011, 2008, 2007, 2006, 2005

Overview

Having failed to qualify for the AFC Champions League for the first time in 2014, Pakhtakor secured a record 12th appearance in the continental competition after winning a 10th Uzbek League title in dominant fashion in 2014 by posting an unbeaten record. Pakhtakor reached the semi-finals of the first two editions of the AFC Champions League in 2003 and 2004, but have since only progressed beyond the group stage in two of their last nine appearances in the competition. Founded in 1956, Pakhtakor are Uzbekistan's most successful club following a long and distinguished history that includes an appearance in the 1968 Soviet Cup final as well as 22 seasons in the Soviet League before winning the first edition of the Uzbek League in 1992.

Key Players

Striker Igor Sergeev underlined his growing reputation with the winning goal as Uzbekistan beat DPR Korea in the group stage of the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 having top scored with 11 goals for Pakhtakor during the 2014 Uzbek League season. Egor Krimets, who spent the 2013 season on loan with Beijing Guoan, was also included in the Uzbekistan squad at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015. Jamshid Iskanderov was another on duty for Uzbekistan in Australia having been nominated for the 2014 Uzbekistan Football Federation Player of the Year Award. Iskanderov is a product of Pakhtakor's youth system and the midfielder has already amassed significant continental experience having also appeared for Uzbekistan at the AFC U-19 Championship and AFC U-22 Championship.

Coach: Samvel Babayan

Samvel Babayan replaced Murod Ismailov as Pakhtakor coach in January 2014 having previously worked as a club director, vice-president and team manager and led the club to the domestic title following an unbeaten campaign to earn a nomination for the 2014 Uzbekistan Football Federation Coach of the Year Award. Babayan has also previously worked as a team manager for the Uzbekistan national team at various levels including the 2004 AFC Asian Cup.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Nikita Ribkin	20/01/1992
2	DF	Egor Krimets	27/01/1992
3	DF	Nodirbek Yuldoshev	04/10/1996
4	DF	Adnan Orahovac	05/02/1991
5	DF	Akbarjon Ismatullaev	10/01/1991
6	MF	Murod Khalmukhamedov	23/12/1990
7	MF	Kakhi Makharadze	20/10/1987
8	MF	Sherzodbek Karimov	26/01/1989
9	MF	Jaloliddin Masharipov	01/09/1993
10	MF	Jamshid Iskanderov	16/10/1993
11	FW	Igor Sergeev	30/04/1993
12	GK	Alexander Lobanov	04/01/1986
13	MF	Iskandar Shaykulov	26/04/1993
14	DF	Jamshid Boltaboev	03/10/1996
15	MF	Javokhir Sokhibov	01/03/1995
16	FW	Naurizbek Alimov	21/03/1992
18	FW	Bakhodir Pardaev	26/04/1987
20	FW	Anvarjon Soliev	05/02/1978
21	DF	Komoliddin Tadjiev	03/05/1983
22	MF	Sukhrob Nurulloev	04/01/1998
23	DF	Aleksandr Merzlyakov	30/10/1986
24	DF	Davronbek Khashimov	24/11/1992
26	DF	Ibrokhim Abdullaev	05/12/1996
28	MF	Stanislav Andreev	06/05/1988
29	MF	Vladimir Kozak	12/06/1993
30	GK	Abdumavlon Abduljalilov	22/12/1994
31	MF	Jamshid Yusupov	27/01/1997
32	MF	Doston Ibragimov	23/01/1997
33	FW	Timur Khakimov	23/08/1994
34	MF	Sayidkamol Davlatjonov	07/05/1997



Overview

Al Shabab have been regular participants in the AFC Champions League over the past decade and the Saudi Pro League side will appear in the competition for the ninth time in 11 seasons in 2015 after lifting the King's Cup in 2014 following a 3-0 win over Al Ahli in the final. Having finished as runner-up in the Asian Club Championship in 1992, Al Shabab won the Asian Cup Winners' Cup in 2001, while their best result in the AFC Champions League era arrived in 2010 as they reached the semi-finals. Al Shabab have twice seen their AFC Champions League aspirations ended by away goals as they were eliminated by Korea Republic's Seongnam Ilhwa Chunma in the semi-finals 2010 and Japan's Kashiwa Reysol in the 2013 quarter-finals.

Key Players

Saudi Arabia striker Naif Hazazi has continued his goalscoring form for Al Shabab since moving from hometown club Al Ittihad in 2013. With Al Ittihad, Hazazi scored eight goals as Al Ittihad reached the semi-finals of the 2012 AFC Champions League and played a part in the two-time champions' run to the 2009 final. Currently on loan from Kuwait SC, Brazilian forward Rogerinho was named 2012 AFC Foreign Player of the Year and claimed the AFC Cup on three occasions with the Kuwaiti side. Ahmed Otaf is a two-time Saudi league winner with Al Shabab having spent his entire career with the club. He was part of Saudi Arabia's squad at the 2011 AFC Asian Cup. Younger brother Abdoh returned from local rivals Al Nassr having begun his career with Al Shabab alongside Ahmed.

Coach: Jaime Pacheco

After a successful career as a player in Portugal, Jaime Pacheco took charge of several lower league clubs in his country before coaching Boavista, Vitoria Guimaraes and Belenenses. He then moved to Saudi Arabia for his first stint with Al Shabab in 2009, but Pacheco only spent one season with the club before joining Beijing Guoan of China for two years. He then coached Egypt's Zamalek in 2014 before returning to Al Shabab.



Qualified as: King's Cup – Winner • **Founded:** 1947 • **Ground:** Prince Faisal Bin Fahad Stadium, Riyadh (22,500)
Saudi League (6): 2012, 2006, 2004, 1993, 1992, 1991
King's Cup (3): 2014, 2009, 2008
Crown Prince Cup (3): 1999, 1996, 1993
AFC Champions League: Semi-Finals 2010; Quarter-Finals 2013; 2006; Round of 16 2014, 2011, 2009; Group Stage 2007, 2005
Asian Club Championship: Runners-up 1992
Asian Cup Winners' Cup (1): 2001 • **Asian Super Cup:** Runners-up 2001

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Waleed Abdullah	19/04/1986
2	DF	Abdullah Al Astaa	24/08/1986
3	DF	Sayyaf Al Bishi	18/06/1980
4	DF	Amer Harun	27/08/1992
5	DF	Tareq Khattab	06/05/1992
6	MF	Omar Al Ghamadi	11/04/1979
7	MF	Rafinha	04/08/1983
8	MF	Abdulmajeed Al Sulayhim	15/05/1994
9	FW	Naif Hazazi	27/07/1988
11	MF	Ahmed Otaf	14/04/1983
12	MF	Abdulmalek Al Khaibri	13/03/1986
13	DF	Hassan Fallatah	27/01/1986
14	DF	Abdullah Shuhail	22/01/1985
15	MF	Abdoh Otaf	02/04/1984
17	FW	Mousa Al Shammari	28/04/1986
18	MF	Abdulmajeed Al Ruwaili	28/08/1986
22	GK	Mohammed Awaji	22/10/1994
23	DF	Mohammed Awal	01/05/1988
25	DF	Majed Al Marshadi	11/01/1984
26	MF	Abdulaziz Al Bishi	11/03/1994
27	MF	Saeed Al Dosari	15/07/1990
30	MF	Bader Al Seliteen	16/07/1990
33	GK	Mohammed Al Owais	10/10/1991
35	MF	Hassan Raghfawi	15/09/1995
39	MF	Abdulrahman Khayrallah	23/02/1996
45	MF	Nader Al Muwalad	23/07/1992
50	MF	Mansour Ali	19/03/1995
80	MF	Abdulrahman Al Khaibary	03/02/1988
91	FW	John Antwi	06/08/1992

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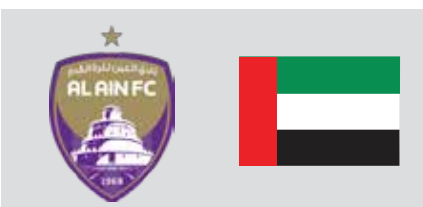


At the heart of the image

GROUP B

Al Ain

United Arab Emirates



Qualified as: President's Cup – Winner • **Founded:** 1968 • **Ground:** Hazza Bin Zayed Stadium, Al Ain (25,000)
Arabian Gulf League (11): 2013, 2012, 2004, 2003, 2002, 2000, 1998, 1993, 1984, 1981, 1977
President's Cup (6): 2014, 2009, 2006, 2005, 2001, 1999
AFC Champions League (1): 2003; Runner-up 2005; Semi-Finals 2014; Quarter-Finals 2006, 2004; Group Stage 2013, 2011, 2010, 2007
Asian Club Championship: Semi-Finals 1999
Asian Cup Winners' Cup: Quarter-Finals 2002

Overview

Al Ain entered the history books in 2003 when they won the inaugural AFC Champions League with a 2-1 aggregate victory over BEC Tero Sasana of Thailand. The Emirati club also finished runners-up in 2005 and reached the semi-finals in 2014 before losing to Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal 4-2 on aggregate despite winning the second leg 2-1 at home. Al Ain won back-to-back Arabian Gulf League titles in 2012 and 2013, but only managed a sixth place finish in 2014 although they still ensured qualification for the AFC Champions League for the 10th time after beating league winners Al Ahli 1-0 in the UAE President's Cup final.

Key Players

One of Asia's brightest stars, playmaker Omar Abdulrahman was one of the leading lights as the United Arab Emirates finished third at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015. Abdulrahman has already helped the UAE win the 2008 AFC U-19 Championship and 2013 Gulf Cup, where he was named MVP, while also featuring at the 2009 FIFA U-20 World Cup and 2012 Olympic Games. Ghana striker Asamoah Gyan plundered 12 goals in last year's AFC Champions League to earn the top scorer accolade, while chipping in with eight league goals during the 2013/14 season. Korea Republic international midfielder Lee Myung-joo joined Al Ain in June 2014 in the most expensive transfer involving the K-League Classic and was part of Korea Republic's squad that finished runners-up at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015.

Coach: Zlatko Dalic

Zlatko Dalic replaced Quique Flores as Al Ain coach in March 2014 and led the side to victory in the UAE President's Cup final and the semi-finals of the AFC Champions League. Dalic started his coaching career in 2005 and went on to helm several clubs in Croatia and Albania before moving to Saudi Arabia in 2010 to join Al Faisaly. He went on to take on a role at fellow Saudi Arabian side Al Hilal, initially with the reserves, before leading the first team to the Crown Prince Cup.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
3	FW	Asamoah Gyan	22/11/1985
5	DF	Ismail Ahmed	07/07/1983
8	MF	Rashed Eisa	24/08/1990
9	FW	Jires Kembo Ekoko	08/01/1988
10	MF	Omar Abdulrahman	20/09/1991
11	FW	Saeed Al Katheeri	28/03/1988
12	GK	Waleed Salem	28/10/1980
13	FW	Khalifa Rashed	01/12/1993
14	DF	Souad Musabbeh	21/05/1993
15	DF	Khaled Abdulrahman	10/09/1988
16	FW	Mohamed Abdulrahman	04/02/1989
17	GK	Khalid Eisa	15/09/1989
18	MF	Ibrahim Diaky	24/05/1982
19	DF	Mohanad Salem	01/03/1985
20	MF	Helal Saeed	12/05/1977
21	DF	Fawzi Fayez	14/07/1987
22	GK	Mahmood Almas	08/09/1983
23	DF	Mohamed Ahmed	16/04/1989
24	MF	Ahmed Barman	05/02/1994
29	MF	Lee Myung-joo	24/04/1990
37	DF	Rashed Muhayer	20/02/1994
38	DF	Saeed Musabbeh	04/02/1994
40	GK	Mohammed Bu Sanda	20/06/1995
43	MF	Rayan Yaslam	23/11/1994
44	DF	Fares Juma	30/12/1988
49	DF	Salem Juma	25/02/1993
50	DF	Mohammed Fayez	06/10/1989
55	GK	Sultan Mohammed	09/05/1994
77	DF	Mohamed Fawzi	22/02/1990
99	MF	Miroslav Stoch	19/10/1989



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GROUP B

Naft Tehran

Iran



Qualified as: Iran Pro League - Third via play-offs • Founded: 1950 • Ground: Azadi Stadium, Tehran (100,000)

Overview

Amir Motahhari's goal was enough to secure Naft Tehran's first-ever appearance in the AFC Champions League group stage after the Iran Pro League side recorded a 1-0 win over Qatar's El Jaish in the final round of the play-offs. Having been established by the National Iranian Oil Company in 1950, Naft did not compete in the top tier until they won promotion to the Iran Pro League in 2010. They finished fifth on two occasions before they mounted a strong campaign last year that saw Naft finish only three points behind eventual champions Foolad Khuzestan after losing 1-0 to Sepahan in their final match of the season.

Key Players

Vahid Amiri broke into the Iran national team in time for the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 and the Naft Tehran winger played a part in two games in the tournament after starting the Group C decider against the United Arab Emirates before coming off the bench at half-time of the thrilling quarter-final defeat by Iraq. Brazilian Leandro Padovani has been an ever-present for Naft since his transfer from Foolad Khuzestan ahead of the 2014/15 season and the defender has also proven himself a threat in front of goal netting five times in his first 20 league games. Also joining Naft from Foolad Khuzestan in time for the 2014/15 season, forward Gholamreza Rezaei netted three times for his former club in the 2014 AFC Champions League. Former Iran international Rezaei represented Iran at the 2011 AFC Asian Cup and scored against Iraq.

Coach: Alireza Mansourian

Former Iran international Alireza Mansourian returned to the helm of an Iran Pro League side with his appointment as coach of Naft Tehran in the summer of 2014 after a five year absence from the domestic top flight following a four month spell in charge of Pas Hamedan in 2009. After leaving Pas, Mansourian joined the national team set-up as assistant to Afshin Ghotbi before serving as interim coach. Mansourian then spent three years as coach of the Iran U-23 side. As a player, the former midfielder played for clubs in Singapore, Greece and Germany before ending his playing career with Esteghlal.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Alireza Beiranvand	21/09/1992
2	MF	Mehdi Shiri	31/01/1991
4	DF	Siamak Kooroshi	27/12/1989
5	DF	Mohammad Amin Hajmohammadi	14/02/1991
6	MF	Alireza Ezati	31/01/1987
7	MF	Hossein Ebrahimi	03/08/1990
8	MF	David Wirikom	28/08/1990
9	MF	Vahid Amiri	02/04/1988
10	FW	Gholamreza Rezaei	06/03/1984
11	MF	Kamal Kamyabinia	18/01/1989
12	DF	Meysam Joudaki	03/02/1995
13	DF	Vahid Hamdinejad	23/08/1982
14	DF	Saeid Lotfi	16/07/1992
16	MF	Abbas Bozar	08/07/1992
17	DF	Bahram Dabbagh	24/07/1992
20	DF	Leandro Padovani	21/12/1983
22	DF	Reza Aliyari	15/03/1994
23	MF	Iman Mobali	03/11/1982
27	MF	Arash Rezavand	05/10/1993
30	GK	Ahmad Gohari	12/01/1996
31	FW	Ali Ghorbani	18/09/1990
40	GK	Vahid Sheikhveisi	10/01/1987
66	MF	Morteza Pouraliganji	19/04/1992
77	FW	Amir Motahhari	10/03/1993
88	FW	Donovan Deekman	23/06/1988
99	GK	Ali Mohsenzadeh	14/02/1993

GROUP C

Foolad Khouzestan

Iran





Line-Up



Qualified as: Iran Pro League - Champion • **Founded:** 1986 • **Ground:** Ghadir Stadium, Ahvaz (51,000)

Iran Pro League (2): 2014, 2005

AFC Champions League: Round of 16 2014; Group Stage 2006

Overview

Making just their second appearance in the AFC Champions League in 2014, Foolad Khouzestan were eliminated from the tournament without losing a game. Having topped their group ahead of Uzbekistan’s Bunyodkor with four wins and two draws from their six games, Foolad bowed out in the Round of 16 after being beaten on away goals by former champions Al Sadd after drawing the second leg 2–2 at home following a goalless stalemate in Qatar. Foolad, though, went onto win the Iran Pro League championship for only a second time in 2014 after finishing two points ahead of runners-up Persepolis following a dramatic 1–0 win over Gostaresh Foolad Tabriz on the final day of the season.

Key Players

Iran midfielder Soroush Rafiei was an important part of Foolad Khouzestan’s 2014 Iran Pro League championship winning side along with Mehdi Badrlou. Rafiei was part of Iran’s squad at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 and featured against Bahrain and the United Arab Emirates in the group stage. Badrlou, who joined Foolad from Saba Qom ahead of the 2013/14 season and helped win the league title, is a gifted defensive midfielder who anchors the side and presents a solid shield for the backline. Former Standard Liege and Levante forward Aloys Nong joined Foolad at the end of 2014 and the Cameroonian striker will look to fill the goalscoring boots of Brazilian striker Chimba who joined Sepahan.

Coach: Dragan Skocic

Former Croatia midfielder Dragan Skocic joined Foolad Khouzestan in 2014 having initially moved to Iran a year earlier with Malavan following a second spell with former club Rijeka. Skocic had first moved to the region to coach Kuwait’s Al Arabi and Saudi Arabia’s Al Nassr. Following a playing career in Croatia, Spain and the United Arab Emirates, Skocic joined former club Rijeka as coach in 2005 having retired four years earlier and led the side to success in the Croatian Cup on two occasions before joining Slovenia’s Interblock Ljubljana.

GROUP C

Lokomotiv

Uzbekistan





Line-Up



Qualified as: Uzbek Cup – Winner/Uzbek League – Runner-up • **Founded:** 2002

Ground: Lokomotiv Stadium, Tashkent (8,200)

Uzbek League: Runner-up 2014, 2013

Uzbek Cup (1): 2014

Overview

Formed in 2002, Lokomotiv enjoyed their best season to date in 2014 when they finished runners-up in the Uzbek League for the second year in a row and captured their first piece of domestic silverware as Jasur Khasanov’s extra-time winner secured a 1–0 win over Bunyodkor in the Uzbek Cup final. And having lost in the play-offs for the past two seasons, the win finally earned Lokomotiv a place in the group stage of the AFC Champions League. In the 2013 play-offs, Lokomotiv were edged out 3–2 by Al Nasr of the United Arab Emirates before losing 3–1 to Kuwait SC at the same stage in 2014.

Key Players

Midfielder Timur Kapadze is the most capped player for Uzbekistan with over a century of appearances for the national team. Kapadze has also a wealth of experience in the AFC Champions League having reached the semi-finals twice with Pakhtakor in 2003 and 2004 and once with Bunyodkor in 2008. Uzbekistan goalkeeper Ignatyi Nesterov joined Lokomotiv ahead of the 2014 campaign after a five-year spell with Bunyodkor. Nesterov helped Uzbekistan reach the quarter-finals of the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015. Centre-back Islom Tukhtakhujayev is now into his fourth season with Lokomotiv and the 25-year-old will look to continue the good form that saw him named in Uzbekistan’s AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 squad in January. The defender had previously represented his country at the youth level having participated in the 2008 AFC U–19 Championship as well as at U–23 level.

Coach: Vadim Abramov

Former Uzbekistan coach Vadim Abramov rejoined Lokomotiv in 2014 and steered his former club to victory in the Uzbek Cup and a second place finish in the league. Abramov enjoyed his first stint with Lokomotiv in 2008, three years before leading Uzbekistan to the semi-finals of the 2011 AFC Asian Cup. Born in Azerbaijan, Abramov had a short football career as a player before taking charge of Pakhtakor in 1988. He was named Uzbekistan Coach of the Year in 2011.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Ignatyi Nesterov	20/06/1983
3	DF	Shavkatjon Mulladjanov	19/01/1986
4	MF	Boburbek Yuldashov	08/04/1993
7	FW	Ruslan Korian	15/06/1988
8	MF	Sardor Mirzayev	21/03/1991
9	MF	Dilshod Rakhmatullaev	17/02/1989
10	MF	Marat Bikmaev	01/01/1986
11	FW	Termurkhujia Andukholikov	25/09/1991
13	MF	Lutfulla Turaev	30/03/1988
16	MF	Jasur Khasanov	24/07/1989
17	FW	Salim Mustafayev	07/03/1991
18	MF	Timur Kapadze	05/09/1981
20	DF	Islom Tukhtakhujayev	30/10/1989
21	MF	Karen Abramov	30/04/1994
22	MF	Sanjar Shaakhmedov	23/09/1990
23	DF	Sardor Rakhmanov	09/07/1994
24	MF	Ibrokhimjon Rakhimov	29/09/1984
28	MF	Ikromjon Alibaev	09/01/1994
30	GK	Sardor Kobuljanov	02/02/1987
33	MF	Oleg Zoteev	05/07/1989
34	FW	Doniyor Usmanov	07/06/1994
36	DF	Khurshidbek Mukhtorov	09/02/1994
41	MF	Kuvondik Ruziev	06/10/1994
44	GK	Aborjon Karimov	29/07/1994
77	MF	Jasur Khasanov	02/08/1983
87	DF	Sakhob Juraev	19/01/1987
97	FW	Alisher Shagulyamov	02/06/1994



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GROUP C

Al Hilal

Saudi Arabia



Qualified as: Saudi League – Runner-up • **Founded:** 1957
Ground: King Fahd International Stadium, Riyadh (67,000)
Saudi League (13): 2011, 2010, 2008, 2005, 2002, 1998, 1996, 1990, 1988, 1986, 1985, 1979, 1977
King's Cup (6): 1989, 1984, 1982, 1980, 1965, 1962
Crown Prince Cup (12): 2013, 2012, 2011, 2010, 2009, 2008, 2006, 2005, 2003, 2000, 1995, 1965
AFC Champions League: Runner-up 2014; Semi-Finals 2010; Quarter-Finals 2012, 2007; Round of 16 2013, 2011, 2009; Group Stage 2006, 2004, 2003 • **Asian Club Championship (2):** 2000, 1991; Runner-up 1986
Asian Cup Winners' Cup (2): 2002, 1997; Semi-Finals 1990 • **Asian Super Cup (2):** 2000, 1997

Overview

Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal fell just short of landing a record-equalling third continental crown at the end of 2014 after losing the AFC Champions League final 1-0 on aggregate to Australia's Western Sydney Wanderers. Al Hilal previously won the Asian Club Championship in 1991 and 2000, while also winning the Asian Cup Winners' Cup and Asian Super Cup on two occasions. Prior to 2014, Al Hilal's best performance in the AFC Champions League arrived in 2010 as they reached the semi-finals before losing to Iran's Zobahan. Al Hilal have also claimed a record 13 Saudi League titles, but finished just two points behind champions Al Nassr in 2014.

Key Players

A back-to-back AFC Champions League winner in 2004 and 2005 with Al Ittihad, veteran midfielder Saud Kariri helped Al Hilal to the final in last year's competition. The hugely experienced Saudi Arabia international, who boasts over 120 caps for his country, has appeared in four AFC Asian Cups as well as the 2006 FIFA World Cup. Kariri's leadership on the field will be especially important for Al Hilal in the absence of the suspended striker and 2014 AFC Player of the Year Nassir Al Shahrani. Centre-back Kwak Tae-hwi captained Ulsan Hyundai to victory in the 2012 AFC Champions League. Kwak was one of the stand-out performers for Korea Republic in their run to the final of the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015. Former Heerenveen, Manchester City and Celtic strike Georgios Samaras joined Al Hilal in February 2015 having represented Greece at the FIFA World Cup on two occasions.

Coach: Giorgos Donis

Former Greece international Giorgos Donis took over the Al Hilal helm following the departure of Romanian Laurentiu Reghecampf ahead of the start of the AFC Champions League in February. Having coached in his homeland at Larissa, with whom he won the Greek Cup; AEK Athens, Atromitos and PAOK, Donis moved to Cypriot side APEOL where he claimed the league and cup double during the 2013/14 season and also was in charge of the side during their UEFA Champions League campaign.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Khalid Sharahili	03/02/1987
4	DF	Abdulla Al Dossary	13/08/1987
7	MF	Thiago Neves	27/02/1985
9	MF	Hamad Al Hamad	26/08/1987
10	MF	Mohammed Al Shalhoub	08/12/1980
11	MF	Abdulaziz Al Dawsari	11/10/1988
12	DF	Yasir Al Shahrani	25/05/1992
13	MF	Salman Al Faraj	01/08/1989
14	MF	Saud Kariri	08/07/1980
15	FW	Al Shahrani	23/11/1983
16	FW	Yousef Al Salem	04/05/1985
17	DF	Abdullah Al Hafith	25/12/1992
18	MF	Abdullah Otayf	03/08/1992
19	FW	Khalid Kaabi	23/05/1992
22	GK	Fahad Al Thunayyan	29/08/1986
23	DF	Kwak Tae-hwi	08/07/1981
24	MF	Nawaf Al Abid	26/01/1990
25	MF	Faisal Darwish	23/04/1990
26	DF	Digao	07/05/1988
28	GK	Abdullah Al Sdairy	02/02/1992
29	MF	Salem Al Dawsari	19/08/1991
32	GK	Faiz Al Subaiei	09/10/1982
33	DF	Sultan Al Duayyi	07/03/1993
35	DF	Ahmed Sharahili	08/05/1994
38	DF	Mohammed Al Baqawi	12/07/1995
49	DF	Abdullah Al Shamekh	28/05/1993
58	DF	Abdulmajed Al Suwat	21/04/1995
70	DF	Mohammed Jahfali	24/10/1990
77	FW	Georgios Samaras	21/02/1985

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GROUP C

Al Sadd

Qatar



Qualified as: Emir Cup – Winner • **Founded:** 1969
Ground: Sheik Jassim Bin Hamad Stadium, Doha (15,000)
Qatar Stars League (13): 2013, 2007, 2006, 2004, 2000, 1989, 1988, 1987, 1981, 1980, 1979, 1974, 1972
Emir Cup (14): 2014, 2007, 2005, 2003, 2001, 2000, 1994, 1991, 1988, 1986, 1985, 1982, 1977, 1975
AFC Champions League (1): 2011; Quarter-Finals 2014, 2005; Group Stage 2010, 2008, 2007, 2006, 2004, 2003
Asian Club Championship (1): 1989
Asian Cup Winners' Cup: Semi-Finals 2002; Quarter-Finals 1995

Overview

Al Sadd earned a spot in the AFC Champions League qualifiers with a 3-0 win over Al Sailiya in the 2014 Emir Cup final and then the 2011 champions secured their 10th appearance in the group stage after consecutive penalty shoot-out victories over Al Riffa of Bahrain and then Al Wahda of the United Arab Emirates in the play-offs. Twice crowned champions of Asia following their victories in the Asian Club Championship in 1989 and the AFC Champions League in 2011, the Doha club suffered a pair of heavy defeats during last year's tournament but reached the quarter-finals before bowing out to eventual finalists Al Hilal of Saudi Arabia after losing 1-0 on aggregate.

Key Players

Qatar striker Khalfan Ibrahim continues to be Al Sadd's icon and the forward scored a hat-trick in the play-off success over Al Wahda which eventually led to a return to the group stage of the AFC Champions League. Ibrahim was named AFC Player of the Year in 2006 at the age of just 18-years-old after impressing at the 2005 FIFA U-17 World Cup and the 2006 Asian Games where he was part of Qatar's gold-medal winning side. Having joined Al Sadd in 2004, Ibrahim has helped the club win four league titles as well as the 2011 AFC Champions League. Hassan Al Haydos is another product of Al Sadd's youth academy and the forward was named 2014 Qatar Footballer of the Year. Brazilian striker Grafite joined Al Sadd in February after a hugely successful three-and-a-half year spell with Al Ahli in the United Arab Emirates where he scored 63 goals in 79 league games.

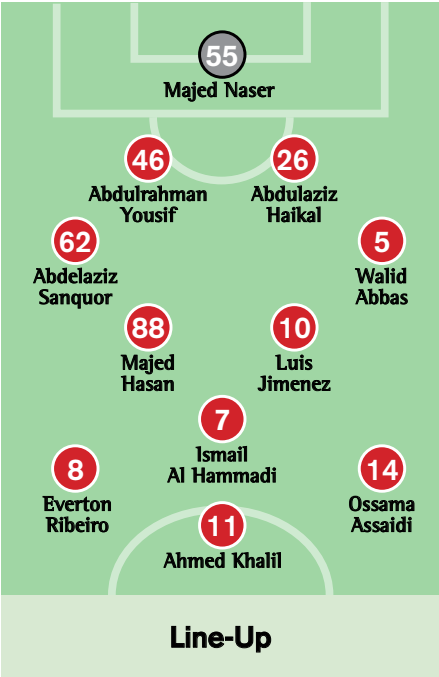
Coach: Lhoussaine Ammouta

Lhoussaine Ammouta returned to Al Sadd in 2011 as technical director before succeeding Uruguayan coach Jorge Fossati a year later and leading the club to their first league title since 2007. Last season, Ammouta helped Al Sadd to the 2014 Emir Cup, a title he also won as a player with Al Sadd before adding the league title and the Sheikh Jassem Cup in 2000, with success in the Emir Cup also arriving in the following year.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Saad Al Sheeb	19/02/1990
3	DF	Abdelkarim Hassan	28/08/1993
5	DF	Ali Al Mahdi	02/03/1992
6	DF	Mohammed Kasola	13/08/1986
8	MF	Ali Asadalla	19/01/1993
9	FW	Muriqui	16/06/1986
10	FW	Khalfan Ibrahim	18/02/1988
11	MF	Hasan Al Haydos	11/12/1990
13	DF	Ibrahim Majed	12/05/1990
15	MF	Talal Al Bloushi	22/05/1986
17	FW	Saleh Bader	10/02/1993
18	MF	Omar Yahya	20/06/1992
19	DF	Naser Nabeel	11/02/1990
20	FW	Yusef Ahmed	14/10/1988
22	GK	Muhammad Naim	01/01/1993
27	MF	Jasser Medany	19/12/1992
29	MF	Ayoub Mashhoor	13/01/1995
30	GK	Mohamed Saqr	17/05/1981
32	FW	Grafite	02/04/1979
37	FW	Hamza Sanhaji	22/04/1994
39	MF	Nadir Belhadj	18/06/1982
40	DF	Lee Jung-soo	08/01/1980
70	MF	Musaab Khidir	01/01/1993
80	MF	Abdulla Al Misaiki	01/01/1995
90	DF	Meshaal Al Shamari	19/01/1995
94	FW	Hamad Mansoor	13/08/1994
96	DF	Abdulrahman Nasser	16/02/1991

GROUP D

Al Ahli
United Arab Emirates



Qualified as: Arabian Gulf League – Winner • **Founded:** 1970 • **Ground:** Rashed Stadium, Dubai (9,390)

Arabian Gulf League (6): 2014, 2009, 2006, 1980, 1976, 1975

President's Cup (8): 2013, 2008, 2004, 2002, 1996, 1978, 1977, 1974

AFC Champions League: Group Stage 2014, 2010, 2009, 2005

Overview

Al Ahli claimed their sixth league title in the United Arab Emirates and first since 2009 in 2014 after finishing the season 16 points clear of runners-up Al Wahda. Al Ahli also won the League Cup, but were denied a domestic treble after losing 1-0 to Al Ain in the President's Cup final. The Dubai-based club, though, have yet to make an impression in the AFC Champions League after failing to progress beyond the group stage in their four previous appearances having also lost in the play-offs for the 2002/03 tournament. Last year, Al Ahli were in contention to progress to the Round of 16 heading into the final round of fixtures, but lost to Qatar's Al Sadd to finish a point short of qualifying for the knockout stage.

Key Players

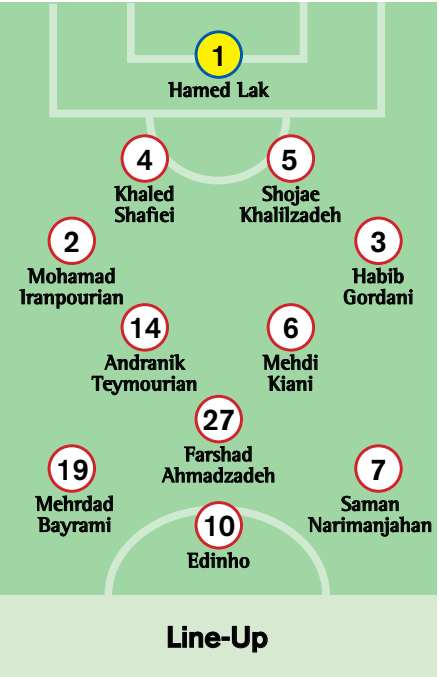
In a much-celebrated coup, Al Ahli signed Brazil international Everton Ribeiro in January 2015 after the attacking midfielder was linked with Manchester United and AC Milan. The former Cruzeiro midfielder was named 2013 Brazil Player of the Year. Ahmed Khalil was part of an exciting United Arab Emirates attack at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 and he netted four times in Australia including two goals in the third place play-off victory over Iraq. The 2008 AFC U-19 Championship MVP has progressed through the ranks at Al Ahli and scored his first league goal aged just 16. Ismail Al Hammadi was also part of the side at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 and the former UAE Football League Rookie of the Year and former Best Emirati Player also impressed in Australia as the forward featured in five games.

Coach: Cosmin Olaroiu

Romanian Cosmin Olaroiu joined Al Ahli in 2013 and led the club to win the league title, the Super Cup and UAE League Cup having also helped rivals Al Ain win the previous two league titles. Olaroiu led Steaua Bucharest to the Romanian league title in 2006 just a year before joining Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal. He continued his success in Saudi Arabi by winning the league title in 2008 before moving to Qatar's Al Sadd in 2009. Olaroiu also coached Saudi Arabia at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015.

GROUP D

Tractorsazi Tabriz
Iran



Qualified as: Hazfi Cup – Winner • **Founded:** 1970 • **Ground:** Yadegar Emam Stadium, Tabriz (67,858)

Hazfi Cup (1): 2014

AFC Champions League: Group Stage 2014, 2013

Overview

Tractorsazi Tabriz won their first domestic honour in 2014 when they lifted the Hazfi Cup after a 1-0 victory over Mes Kerman in the final having narrowly missed out on league titles in both 2012 and 2013. It was a long awaited success for Tractorsazi who enjoy some of the most passionate support in Iran. Back-to-back runner-up finishes in the Iran Pro League in 2012 and 2013 had, though, earned Tractorsazi their first appearances in the AFC Champions League. On their debut in 2013, Tractorsazi picked up four points from their six games, while in 2014 they went one better and posted one win and two draws.

Key Players

Andranik Teymourian returned to Tractorsazi Tabriz prior to featuring for Iran at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 having previously played for the club during the 2010/11 season. The former Bolton Wanderers and Fulham midfielder was named the 2014 Iranian Football Federation Player of the Year following his efforts with the national team at the 2014 FIFA World Cup and domestic side Esteghlal. Teymourian was a virtual-ever present for Iran at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015, missing only a handful of minutes. He also played for Esteghlal during the last three editions of the AFC Champions League. Brazilian striker Edinho joined Tractorsazi in July 2014 following spells with fellow Iran Pro League side Mes Kerman and Emirati club Al Sharjah. A versatile utility player who is comfortable across the backline and in a defensive midfield role, Habib Gordani has played his entire career in the city of Tabriz with Shardari Tabriz before joining Tractorsazi in 2012.

Coach: Antonio Oliveira

Portuguese coach Antonio 'Toni' Oliveira rejoined Tractorsazi Tabriz in February. Now in his third spell with Tractorsazi, Oliveira saw out a six month stint last year with the Iran Pro League side which encompassed the 2014 AFC Champions League campaign, while his initial period in charge came before the start of the 2012 season as he oversaw a second place finish in the domestic league as well as the club's maiden AFC Champions League campaign in 2013.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Hamed Lak	24/11/1990
2	DF	Mohammad Iranpourian	21/09/1985
3	DF	Habib Gordani	09/06/1983
4	DF	Khaled Shafiei	29/03/1987
5	DF	Shojae Khalilzadeh	14/05/1989
6	MF	Mehdi Kiani	10/01/1987
7	MF	Saman Narimanjahan	18/04/1991
8	FW	Shahin Saghebi	25/08/1993
9	FW	Farid Karimi	14/05/1989
10	FW	Edinho	31/05/1982
12	MF	Mohammad Pourrahmatollah	01/01/1995
14	MF	Andranik Teymourian	06/03/1983
15	DF	Mirmahdi Ghoreishi	18/05/1990
17	MF	Sina Ashoori	16/09/1988
18	MF	Ahmad Kamdar	05/01/1989
19	FW	Mehrdad Bayrami	21/09/1990
21	FW	Mohsen Delir	03/07/1988
23	DF	Hani Hashemi	21/03/1983
25	MF	Reza Faraji	21/01/1995
27	FW	Farshad Amhadzadeh	23/09/1992
29	FW	Peyman Keshavarzi	06/03/1995
33	MF	Shirvand Shahryar	21/03/1991
40	DF	Ali Hamoudi	21/03/1986
44	GK	Issa Ndoye	12/12/1985
45	GK	Mohammadali Ramazanian	20/02/1993
77	MF	Saeid Aghaei	09/02/1995
88	MF	Fardin Abedini	18/11/1991

GROUP D

Nasaf

Uzbekistan



Qualified as: Uzbek League – Third Place • **Founded:** 1997 • **Ground:** Central Stadium, Karshi (16,000)
AFC Champions League: Group Stage 2012
Asian Club Championship: Semi-Finals 2002
AFC Cup (1): 2011

Overview

Nasaf made history in 2011 when they became the first club from Uzbekistan to win a continental title after beating Kuwait SC 2-1 in the AFC Cup Final. Nasaf made their AFC Champions League debut the following year and picked up one point from their six games before also losing in the continental play-offs to Qatar's El Jaish in 2014. But Nasaf, who reached the semi-finals of the final edition of the Asian Club Championship in 2002 before losing to eventual winners Suwon Samsung, secured a second appearance in the group stage of the AFC Champions League in 2015 after claiming a third place finish in the Uzbek League last year.

Key Players

Turkmenistan striker Artur Gevorkyan was named the Uzbek League top scorer in 2014 with 18 goals having missed out in the previous year to Bunyodkor's Oleksandr Pyshur. Gevorkyan scored four goals as Nasaf won the AFC Cup in 2011 before appearing in the AFC Champions League the following year having previously played in the continental competition for Pakhtakor in 2010 when the striker scored twice. Ilkhom Shomurodov is in his second spell with Nasaf following a loan spell with Bunyodkor having scored three goals during the successful AFC Cup campaign in 2011. Shomurodov was Nasaf's second highest scorer in the league last season, behind Gevorkyan, with seven goals. Ilkhom Yunusov has been a regular for Nasaf since the midfielder joined in 2011 from Dinamo Samarqand.

Coach: Ruziqul Berdiev

Former player Ruziqul Berdiev was assistant coach to Anatoliy Demyanenko as Nasaf won the AFC Cup in 2011 before succeeding the Ukrainian at the start of the following season. Berdiev, who initially joined the Nasaf coaching staff in 2009, has since led the club to two runner-up finishes in the Uzbek League. As a player, Berdiev joining newly-formed Nasaf in 1997 and went onto play over 300 games over the next 12 seasons. He helped Nasaf reach the Asian Club Championship semi-finals in 2002 before retiring in 2008.

GROUP D

Al Ahli

Saudi Arabia



Qualified as: Saudi Pro League – Third via play-offs • **Founded:** 1937
Ground: King Abdullah Sports City Stadium, Jeddah (62,241)
Saudi League (2): 1984, 1978
Crown Prince Cup (6): 2015, 2007, 2002, 1998, 1970, 1957
King's Cup (2): 2012, 2011
AFC Champions League: Runners-up 2012; Quarter-Finals 2013, 2005; Group Stage 2010, 2008
Asian Club Championship: Runner-up 1986
Asian Cup Winners' Cup: Quarter-Finals 2000

Overview

Al Ahli ended the 2013/14 Saudi Pro League season without any silverware after finishing third in the league and losing 3-0 to Al Shabab in the King's Cup final. However, a 2-1 extra-time win over AFC Cup champions Qadsia SC from Kuwait in the play-offs in February earned the 2012 runners-up a return to the group stage of the AFC Champions League for the sixth time. Finalists in the Asian Club Championship in 1986, Al Ahli also reached the AFC Champions League final in 2012 but were beaten 3-0 by Korea Republic's Ulsan Hyundai. On their last appearance in 2013, Al Ahli were eliminated in the quarter-finals by eventual runners-up FC Seoul.

Key Players

Syrian striker Omar Al Soma joined Al Ahli ahead of the 2014/15 season after three hugely successful seasons with Qadsia SC where he won numerous titles including the 2013/14 Kuwaiti Premier League Top Scorer accolade. Al Soma was also on target against his former club as Al Ahli defeated Qadsia SC 2-1 in the play-offs to progress to the AFC Champions League group stage. Boasting over a century of caps for Saudi Arabia, centreback Osama Hawsawi had a hugely successful four year spell with Al Hilal, picking up three league titles and four Crown Prince Cups, which led to a transfer to Anderlecht in 2012. Hawsawi returned to Saudi Arabia and Al Ahli and the defender had established himself as a regular in the side. Captain Taiseer Al Jassam has been at the Jeddah club since 2003 and the goal-scoring midfielder is also a regular for both club and country with over 90 caps for Saudi Arabia.

Coach: Christian Gross

Experienced Swiss coach Christian Gross has enjoyed considerable success in his homeland with six Swiss Super League championships coming from his time at the helm of Grasshopper Club Zurich and FC Basel. Outside of Switzerland, Gross was in charge of Tottenham Hotspur during the 1997/1998 season as well as VFB Stuttgart from December 2009 to October 2010. Gross joined Al Ahli ahead of the 2014/15 season and helped the Jeddah club lift the Crown Prince Cup in February.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Alibek Turobov	21/09/1993
4	DF	Maksud Karimov	02/03/1985
5	DF	Botir Karaev	08/04/1980
6	MF	Azizjon Ganiev	22/02/1988
7	MF	Akramjon Bahritdinov	02/10/1992
9	FW	Ilkhom Shomurodov	28/03/1984
10	FW	Kenja Turaev	01/03/1989
14	DF	Sharof Mukhitdinov	14/07/1997
15	DF	Rok Roj	08/10/1986
17	FW	Artur Gevorkyan	22/11/1984
18	MF	Bakhrom Abdurakhimov	11/12/1988
20	MF	Erkin Baydullaev	04/10/1984
21	GK	Suleyman Akhmedkarimov	16/05/1992
22	MF	Shohruh Gadoev	31/12/1991
23	DF	Sherzod Azamov	14/01/1990
25	GK	Eldorbek Suyunov	12/04/1991
27	MF	Ilhom Yunusov	03/05/1982
28	DF	Shukhrat Mukhammadiev	24/06/1989
29	MF	Khudoberdi Kholikov	01/11/1998
30	GK	Utkir Yusupov	04/01/1991
32	MF	Khamza Karimov	10/12/1980
33	DF	Odiljon Hamrobekov	13/02/1996
34	MF	Farrukh Sayfiev	17/01/1991
38	MF	Doniyorjon Narzullaev	11/04/1995
41	FW	Azamat Allaniyazov	15/10/1989
99	MF	Oleksandr Kablash	05/09/1989

GROUP E

Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors

Korea Republic





Line-Up



Qualified as: K-League Classic – Champion • **Founded:** 1994
Ground: Jeonju World Cup Stadium, Jeonju (43,389)
K-League (3): 2014, 2011, 2009
FA Cup (3): 2005, 2003, 2000
AFC Champions League (1): 2006; Runners-up 2011; Semi-Finals 2004; Quarter-Finals 2010, 2007; Round of 16 2014, 2013; Group Stage 2012
Asian Cup Winners' Cup: Runner-up 2002

Overview

Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors ensured a return to the AFC Champions League for a sixth consecutive season after claiming their third K-League Classic title in 2014, finishing 14 points clear of runners-up Suwon Samsung. Jeonbuk were the first Korean club to win the AFC Champions League in 2006 after posting a 3–2 aggregate victory over Syria’s Al Karamah. Jeonbuk also reached the semi-finals in 2004 and lost the 2011 final on penalties to Qatar’s Al Sadd. Jeonbuk have, though, exited in the Round of 16 in the last two seasons having been eliminated in the group stage for the first time in 2012 with their 2014 campaign ended by domestic rivals Pohang Steelers.

Key Players

Evergreen striker Lee Dong-gook was named the 2014 K-League Classic MVP for a record-breaking third time after netting 13 goals in 31 games as Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors won the domestic title. Lee was named MVP and top scorer as Jeonbuk reached the 2011 AFC Champions League final having earlier won the Asian Club Championship in 1998 with Pohang Steelers. Having joined Jeonbuk from Incheon United ahead of the 2014 season, Han Kyo-won enjoyed a superb first full season at the club as the Korea Republic midfielder scored 11 goals and was named in the K-League’s Best XI. He also made three appearances for Korea at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015. Australian centre-back Alex Wilkinson was also named in the K-League’s Best XI having joined Jeonbuk from Central Coast Mariners in 2012.

Coach: Choi Kang-hee

Choi Kang-hee has enjoyed a glittering career as coach of Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors with the 2014 K-League League Classic title his third domestic crown which earned the former Korea Republic coach a third K-League Manager of the Year accolade, adding to those won in 2009 and 2011. Former Korea Republic defender Choi was also in charge for the 2006 AFC Champions League success and 2011 final appearance. He oversaw Korea’s qualification for the 2014 FIFA World Cup before returning to Jeonbuk in 2013.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Kwoun Sun-tae	11/09/1984
3	DF	Kim Hyung-il	27/04/1984
4	DF	Kim Kee-hee	13/07/1989
5	MF	Lee Ho	22/10/1984
6	MF	Choi Bo-kyung	12/04/1988
7	MF	Han Kyo-won	15/06/1990
8	MF	Eninho	16/05/1981
9	FW	Edu	30/11/1981
10	MF	Leonardo	22/09/1986
11	MF	Lee Sung-hyun	25/07/1985
13	DF	Jung Hoon	31/08/1985
16	DF	Cho Sung-hwan	09/04/1982
17	MF	Lee Jae-sung	10/08/1992
18	DF	Alex Wilkinson	13/08/1984
19	DF	Park Won-jae	28/05/1984
20	FW	Lee Dong-gook	29/04/1979
21	GK	Hong Jung-nam	21/05/1988
22	FW	Lee Sang-hup	03/08/1986
23	FW	Kim Dong-chan	19/04/1986
24	FW	Ryu Chang-hyun	14/05/1985
25	DF	Choi Chul-soon	08/02/1987
26	DF	Lee Jae-moung	25/07/1991
27	DF	Lee Seung-yeoul	03/06/1989
28	MF	Choi Chi-won	11/06/1993
29	DF	Lee Kyu-ro	20/08/1988
30	DF	Kim Young-chan	04/09/1993
32	MF	Lee Ju-yong	26/09/1992
39	FW	Cho Suk-jae	24/03/1993
41	GK	Hwang Byeong-geun	14/06/1994
47	MF	Moon Sang-yun	09/01/1991

GROUP E

Shandong Luneng

China





Line-Up



Qualified as: Chinese FA Cup – Winner • **Founded:** 1956
Ground: Olympic Sports Center Stadium, Jinan (60,000)
Chinese Super League (4): 2010, 2008, 2006, 1999
FA Cup (5): 2014, 2006, 2004, 1999, 1995
AFC Champions League: Quarter-Finals 2005; Group Stage 2014, 2011, 2010, 2009, 2007

Overview

Shandong Luneng return for their seventh AFC Champions League appearance after claiming the FA Cup in dramatic circumstances at the end of 2014 under the guidance of Brazilian coach Cuca. Trailing on away goals to Jiangsu Sainty, Australian centre-back Ryan McGowan scored a 95th winner to snatch the trophy as Shandong completed a sensational 5–4 aggregate victory in Nanjing. Shandong, who were the first side to win the league and cup double in China in 1999, reached the quarter-finals on their AFC Champions League debut in 2005 but have since suffered five group stage exits, including 2014 when the Chinese Super League side picked up five points from their six games with their only win coming in Japan against Cerezo Osaka.

Key Players

Brazil striker Diego Tardelli joined Shandong Luneng at the start of 2015 having played for Qatar’s Al Gharafa in the 2012 AFC Champions League, with the former Sao Paulo and Atletico Mineiro forward netting twice in the group stage. Wang Dalei was named the 2014 Chinese Football Association Goalkeeper of the Year and the former Shanghai Shenhua custodian underlined his position as China’s number one with a string of impressive performances at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 as Alain Perrin’s side reached the quarter-finals. Wang played for Shanghai in the AFC Champions League in 2007, 2009 and 2011 before moving to Shandong ahead of the 2014 season. Liu Bin Bin also enjoyed a standout 2014 as the product of Shandong’s academy was named the Chinese Football Association Young Player of the Year.

Coach: Cuca

Brazilian coach Alexi Stival, who is more commonly known as Cuca, enjoyed a successful first season with Shandong Luneng in 2014 leading the Jinan-based side to their fifth FA Cup and a fourth place finish in the Chinese Super League. Cuca has over 15 years of coaching experience including spells at Brazil’s most prestigious clubs in the form of Gremio, Santos, Fluminense and Flamengo as well as Atletico Mineiro, who he led to their first Copa Libertadores success in 2013.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Yang Cheng	11/10/1985
2	DF	Zhao Mingjian	22/11/1987
3	DF	Dai Lin	28/11/1987
5	DF	Junior Urso	10/05/1989
6	DF	Zheng Zheng	11/07/1989
7	MF	Zhang Wenzhao	28/05/1987
8	FW	Wang Yongpo	19/01/1987
9	FW	Diego Tardelli	10/05/1985
10	MF	Walter Montillo	14/04/1984
11	MF	Liu Bin Bin	16/06/1993
12	MF	Jin Jingdao	18/11/1992
13	MF	Zhang Chi	08/07/1987
14	DF	Wang Tong	12/02/1993
15	MF	Li Wei	18/03/1985
16	DF	Wang Qiang	23/07/1982
17	FW	Wu Xinghan	24/02/1993
18	FW	Han Peng	13/09/1983
19	FW	Yang Xu	12/02/1988
20	GK	Han Rongze	15/01/1993
22	FW	Hao Junmin	24/03/1987
23	GK	Wang Dalei	10/01/1989
24	MF	Qi Tianyu	22/01/1993
25	FW	Cheng Yuan	08/10/1993
26	MF	Cui Wei	16/08/1994
27	DF	Li Songyi	27/01/1993
28	GK	Zhou Yuchen	12/01/1995

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GROUP E

Binh Duong
Vietnam





Line-Up



Qualified as: V.League – Champion • **Founded:** 1976 • **Ground:** Go Dau Stadium, Thu Dau Mot (18,250)

V.League (3): 2014, 2008, 2007

AFC Champions League: Group Stage 2008

Overview

Formerly known as Song Be FC, Binh Duong narrowly edged Hanoi T&T by two points to win the V.League title for a third time in 2014 and ensure a second appearance in the AFC Champions League. Binh Duong were the first Vietnamese side to qualify for the AFC Champions League in 2008, although they were eliminated in the group stage with just one point from their six games after being drawn alongside eventual finalists Adelaide United. Binh Duong, though, have enjoyed success in the AFC Cup having reached the semi-finals in 2009, when they eventually lost 4–2 on aggregate to Syria's Al Karamah, and the Round of 16 in 2010.

Key Players

Le Cong Vinh joined Binh Duong after spending part of 2013 on loan at Japanese club Consadole Sapporo. Widely regarded as one of the best strikers Vietnamese football has ever produced, Cong Vinh is regionally renowned for his goals during Vietnam's successful 2008 AFF Suzuki Cup campaign, while he also scored four goals during the 2014 edition of the regional championship. Senegalese attacking midfielder Abass Cheikh Dieng scored 16 goals as Binh Duong won the 2014 V.League title. Captain and striker Nguyen Anh Duc is a product of Binh Duong's academy set-up and has a vast amount of experience having played in the AFC Champions League and AFC Cup as well as at the 2007 AFC Asian Cup.

Coach: Nguyen Thanh Son

Former Vietnam defender Nguyen Thanh Son was named the 2014 V.League Coach of the Year after leading Binh Duong to a first league title win in six years following his promotion from assistant coach after just five games of the new season. The former Vinh Long and Saigon Port Club defender first moved into coaching in 2006 before taking over as coach of former side Da My Nghe Club in 2006. Thanh Son would go on to join current side Binh Duong three years later in an assistant coaching role following his departure from the Saigon-based side.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Bui Tan Truong	19/02/1986
2	DF	Au Van Hoan	01/10/1989
3	DF	Le Phuoc Tu	15/04/1984
4	DF	Michal Nguyen	04/12/1989
6	DF	Robert Dang Van	27/08/1984
7	MF	Mai Tien Thanh	16/03/1986
8	MF	Moses Oloya	22/10/1992
9	MF	Nguyen Trong Hoang	14/04/1989
10	FW	Abass Cheikh Dieng	01/01/1985
11	FW	Nguyen Anh Duc	24/10/1985
14	MF	Le Tan Tai	04/01/1984
15	FW	Dang Van Thanh	30/09/1984
16	DF	Nguyen Xuan Thanh	10/11/1985
18	FW	Nguyen Tang Tuan	28/06/1986
19	GK	Nguyen Minh Phong	15/09/1986
20	DF	Truong Dinh Luat	12/11/1983
22	MF	Hoang Van Binh	02/02/1989
23	DF	Pham Minh Duc	24/05/1987
24	FW	Nguyen Trung Tin	14/09/1991
26	DF	David Vrankovic	11/11/1993
27	FW	Trinh Quang Vinh	17/03/1987
28	FW	Le Cong Vinh	10/12/1985
29	GK	Nguyen Quoc Thien Esele	29/04/1984
30	FW	Ganiyu Oseni	19/09/1991

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GROUP E

Kashiwa Reysol

Japan



Qualified as: J.League – Fourth via play-offs • Founded: 1940 • Ground: Hitachi Stadium, Kashiwa (15,349)
J.League (1): 2011
Emperor's Cup (3): 2012, 1975, 1972
AFC Champions League: Semi-finals 2013; Round of 16 2012

Overview

A strong finish to the 2014 J.League season saw Kashiwa Reysol win their last seven games to claim fourth place ahead of Sagan Tosu on goal difference. And with Gamba Osaka winning the domestic treble, 2013 semi-finalists Kashiwa entered the play-offs for the AFC Champions League and eventually beat Thailand's Chonburi 3-2 after extra-time to earn a third group stage appearance. Winners of the J.League in 2011, just a season after they had won promotion from the second division, Kashiwa reached the last 16 of the AFC Champions League on their debut in 2012 and went all the way to the semi-finals the following year.

Key Players

Top scorer for Kashiwa Reysol in 2014, Brazilian striker Leandro first played in Japan in 2005 with a loan spell at Omiya Ardija before a four-year stint at Montedio Yamagata, Vissel Kobe and Gamba Osaka. The Sao Paulo-native then enjoyed three goal-laden seasons in Qatar before returning to Japan with Gamba Osaka in 2012 before joining Kashiwa. Defender Daisuke Suzuki was an important component of Kashiwa's run to the 2013 AFC Champions League semi-final and the centre-back made the most appearances for the club in 2014. Japan international Suzuki joined Kashiwa ahead of the 2013 season after a four-year spell at Albirex Niigata. One of the most successful products of the club's youth system, Hidekazu Otani has made over 250 appearances for Kashiwa since making his debut in 2003 and the central midfielder is the club captain.

Coach: Tatsuma Yoshida

Former director of development at Kashiwa Reysol, Tatsuma Yoshida took over from Nelsinho Baptista at the end of the 2014 season after the hugely successful Brazilian coach, who led Kashiwa to the league title in 2011, the 2012 Emperor's Cup as well as the semi-finals of the AFC Champions League semi-finals in 2013, stepped down to join Vissel Kobe. A former midfielder with Kashiwa, Yoshida's first competitive game as coach saw his side defeat Chonburi in extra-time in the AFC Champions League play-off in February to secure a place in the group stage.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Kazushige Kiriha	30/06/1987
2	DF	Masato Fujita	08/05/1986
3	DF	Naoya Kondo	03/10/1983
4	DF	Daisuke Suzuki	29/01/1990
5	DF	Tatsuya Masushima	22/04/1985
6	DF	Ryosuke Yamanaka	20/04/1993
7	MF	Hidekazu Otani	06/11/1984
8	MF	Akimi Barada	30/05/1991
9	FW	Masato Kudo	06/05/1990
10	FW	Yuki Otsu	24/03/1990
11	FW	Leandro	12/02/1985
13	DF	Eduardo	27/04/1993
14	MF	Kenta Kano	02/05/1986
15	MF	Kosuke Taketomi	23/09/1990
16	GK	Koji Inada	19/06/1985
17	MF	Hiroki Akino	08/10/1994
19	MF	Hiroto Nakagawa	03/11/1994
20	DF	Shinnosuke Nakatani	24/03/1996
21	GK	Takanori Sugeno	03/05/1984
22	DF	Naoki Wako	26/11/1989
25	MF	Yusuke Kobayashi	23/10/1994
26	MF	Tetsuro Ota	02/07/1989
27	DF	Kim Chang-soo	12/09/1985
28	MF	Ryoichi Kurisawa	05/09/1982
29	DF	Yuta Nakayama	16/02/1997
30	FW	Cristiano	12/01/1987
31	FW	Koki Oshima	30/05/1996
33	DF	Kakeru Kumagawa	02/04/1997
35	GK	Ryuki Miura	17/05/1992
36	MF	Kensei Ukita	12/06/1997

GROUP F

Gamba Osaka

Japan





Line-Up



Qualified as: J.League – Champion • **Founded:** 1980
Ground: Expo '70 Commemorative Stadium, Osaka (21,000)
J.League (2): 2014, 2005
Emperor's Cup (4): 2014, 2009, 2008, 1990
AFC Champions League (1): 2008; Round of 16 2011, 2010, 2009; Group Stage 2012, 2006

Overview

Winners of the AFC Champions League in 2008, Gamba Osaka hit their lowest point in 2012 when they were relegated from the J.League for the first time. However, Gamba won promotion at the first attempt in 2013 and enjoyed a remarkable campaign last year when they won 15 of their last 20 games to clinch the J.League title, came from two goals down to beat Sanfrecce Hiroshima 3-2 in the J.League Cup final and then became only the second club to complete the Japanese treble with a 3-1 win over Montedio Yamagata in the Emperor's Cup final. Gamba beat Australia's Adelaide United in the 2008 AFC Champions League final, but have failed to progress beyond the Round of 16 since.

Key Players

One of Gamba Osaka's greatest and most decorated servants, Yasuhito Endo has been at the club since 2001 and the Japan midfielder was a key part of their domestic league and cup treble that saw him named 2014 J.League Player of the Year. A national team icon with over 150 appearance for the Samurai Blue, Endo was named AFC Champions League MVP after Gamba's 2008 AFC Champions League success and was also chosen as the 2009 AFC Player of the Year. Takashi Usami emerged as one of the J.League's brightest young stars in 2013 when the striker netted 19 goals in Gamba's successful promotion and the 22-year-old successfully continued that form into the top flight after scoring 21 times in all competitions. With over 80 caps for Japan Yasuyuki Konno is nearing a century of appearances for Gamba after joining from FC Tokyo in 2012.

Coach: Kenta Hasegawa

Former Japan international winger Kenta Hasegawa was appointed Gamba Osaka coach in 2013 after spending six seasons with Shimizu S-Pulse. He led Shimizu to fourth place finishes in 2006 and 2007 as well as two Emperor's Cup finals. And after overseeing Gamba's return to the top-flight after winning the second division crown, Hasegawa won the 2014 J.League Manager of the Year Award after masterminding the historic domestic treble.

GROUP F

Seongnam FC

Korea Republic





Line-Up



Qualified as: FA Cup – Winner • **Founded:** 1989 • **Ground:** Tanchon Sports Complex, Seongnam City (16,000)
K-League (7): 2006, 2003, 2002, 2001, 1995, 1994, 1993
FA Cup (3): 2014, 2011, 1999
AFC Champions League (1): 2010, Runner-up 2004; Semi-Finals 2007; Round of 16 2012; Group Stage 2003
Asian Club Championship (1): 1996; Runner-up 1997
Asian Super Cup (1): 1996

Overview

Seongnam FC, who were known as Seongnam Ilhwa Chunma when they won the AFC Champions League in 2010, narrowly avoided relegation from the K-League Classic in 2014 but secured a spot in the continental competition after lifting the FA Cup for a third time following a penalty shootout victory over FC Seoul in the final. Founded in 1989, Seongnam won the Asian Club Championship and Asian Super Cup in 1996 prior to beating Iran's Zobahan 3-1 in the 2010 AFC Champions League final. Seongnam also reached the AFC Champions League final in 2004 but lost 6-3 on aggregate to Saudi Arabia's Al Ittihad after losing the second leg at home 5-0.

Key Players

Former K-League MVP Kim Do-heon returned to Seongnam FC at the start of 2015 following spells in England with West Bromwich Albion and in Korea Republic with Suwon Samsung. The former Korea international was named the K-League's best player in 2006 after helping Seongnam win the K-League title, while Kim won the Asian Club Championship in 2001 and 2002 with Suwon as well as the English Football League Championship with West Brom in 2008. Versatile defensive midfielder Kim Cheol-ho has been at Seongnam since 2004 and was a key member of the side that lifted the AFC Champions League title in 2010 as well as the K-League crown in 2006, the League Cup in 2004 and FA Cup in 2014. Also brought in ahead of the 2015 season, Brazilian striker Ricardo Bueno has previously played for Atletico Mineiro and Gremio.

Coach: Kim Hak-bum

In his second spell as coach of Seongnam FC, Kim Hak-bum was previously on the coaching staff from 1998-2004 before taking over the helm in 2005. In a successful three year stint, Kim led Seongnam to the K-League title in 2006 as well as the final of the League Cup and was named the K-League Manager of the Year. Kim also had brief spells with Henan Construction in the Chinese Super League and Gangwon FC before returning to his former club in September 2014.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Jeon Sang-wook	22/09/1979
2	DF	Kwak Hae-seong	06/12/1991
3	DF	Sim Woo-yeon	03/04/1985
4	DF	Lee Yo-han	18/12/1985
5	DF	Lim Chai-min	18/11/1990
6	DF	Kim Tae-youn	25/07/1986
7	MF	Kim Cheol-ho	26/09/1983
8	MF	Kim Do-heon	14/07/1982
9	FW	Kim Dong-sub	29/03/1989
10	MF	Jorginho	05/01/1991
11	FW	Ricardo Bueno	15/08/1987
13	FW	Kim Dong-hee	06/05/1989
14	MF	Jung Seon-ho	25/03/1989
16	FW	Hwang Ui-jo	28/08/1992
17	DF	Park Tae-min	21/01/1986
18	MF	Kim Sung-joon	08/04/1988
19	FW	Lucas	19/01/1994
20	DF	Yun Young-sun	04/10/1988
21	GK	Jeong San	10/02/1989
22	MF	Lee Jong-won	14/03/1989
23	MF	Nam Joon-jae	07/04/1988
24	MF	Jang Suk-won	11/08/1989
25	DF	Lee Tae-hee	16/06/1992
26	FW	Moon Chang-hyun	12/11/1992
27	MF	Kang Jin-ouk	13/02/1986
28	DF	Yoo Chung-youn	07/09/1992
29	GK	Park Jun-huk	11/04/1987
30	FW	Seong Bong-jae	29/04/1993
32	DF	Lee Won-gyu	16/07/1992
33	MF	Youm Yu-shin	10/08/1992

GROUP F

Buriram United

Thailand



Qualified as: Thai Premier League – Champion • **Founded:** 1970 • **Ground:** Buriram Stadium, Buriram (24,000)
Thai Premier League (4): 2014, 2013, 2011, 2008
FA Cup (3): 2013, 2012, 2011
AFC Champions League: Quarter-Finals 2013; Group Stage 2014, 2012

Overview

Buriram United, formerly known as Provincial Electricity Authority, have dominated the domestic scene in Thailand since moving to the North-East of the country in 2010 by winning the Premier League in three of the past four seasons and completing the domestic treble in 2011 and 2013. Buriram finished the 2014 season with three successive wins to edge out eventual runner-up Chonburi by three points. Buriram became the first Thai club in a decade to advance to the knockout stage of the AFC Champions League in 2013 after beating Uzbekistan’s Bunyodkor in the Round of 16 before losing out to Iran’s Esteghlal.

Key Players

Veteran captain Suchao Nutnum was named the 2014 Thai Premier League Player of the Year after guiding Buriram United to the domestic title following another standout season for the irrepressible attacking midfielder. The former Thailand international was capped over 50 times for his country before ending his involvement with the national side in 2013. Born and raised in Buriram, former BEC Tero Sasana and Muangthong United winger Jakkaphan Kaewprom returned to his hometown club in 2011 and played a major role in the treble winning season. A knee injury ruined the majority of his 2013 season, but Jakkaphan returned for the title-winning 2014 campaign. Korea Republic midfielder Ko Seul-ki won the AFC Champions League with Ulsan Hyundai in 2012 and joined Buriram at the start of 2015 following a spell in Qatar with El Jaish.

Coach: Alexandre Gama

Alexandre Gama replaced interim coach Bozidar Bandovic at Buriram United midway through the 2014 Thai Premier League season following a period in Qatar with Al Shahania. In his decade of coaching, the Brazilian has already had spells at Fluminense and Internacional in his homeland before a two-year stint with Al Wahda in the United Arab Emirates from 2006–2008. Gama was also in charge of K-League Classic side Gyeongnam before taking on an assistant coach role with Korea Republic which included a trip to the 2011 AFC Asian Cup.

GROUP F

Guangzhou R&F

China



Qualified as: Chinese Super League – Third via play-offs • **Founded:** 1986
Ground: Yuexiushan Stadium, Guangzhou (21,164)

Overview

Guangzhou R&F enjoyed their best season in the Chinese Super League in 2014 when they finished third in the table behind Guangzhou Evergrande and Beijing Guoan. And victories over Singapore’s Warriors FC and Australia’s Central Coast Mariners in the play-offs in February secured a first-ever appearance in the group stage of the AFC Champions League. Guangzhou first eased to a 3–0 home win over Warriors before claiming a hugely impressive 3–1 victory over Central Coast in Australia. Originally formed in Shenyang in 1986, the club was also based in Changsha and Shenzhen before settling in the southern Chinese city of Guangzhou in 2011.

Key Players

Prolific Morocco striker Abderazzaq Hamedallah proved an inspired signing in February 2014 after joining from Norwegian side Aalesunds and scored 22 times in 22 league games in the Chinese Super League as Guangzhou R&F finished third. Hamedallah did not score during the win over Central Coast Mariners in the AFC Champions League play-offs, but was a constant threat. Hamedallah’s strike partner in their historic win over Central Coast, Jiang Ning, netted the crucial opening goal in the 3–1 victory in Gosford. The China forward formerly plied his trade with Qingdao Jonoon and Guangzhou Evergrande. A constant in Guangzhou’s backline last season, left-back Jiang Zhipeng was a member of the national team squad at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 and appeared in all four games as China reached the quarter-finals.

Coach: Cosmin Contra

Former Getafe coach Cosmin Contra was appointed in December following the departure of Sven Goran Eriksson and the Romanian passed his first test to take the club from Southern China into their first-ever AFC Champions League appearance with victories in his first two competitive outings against Warriors FC and Central Coast Mariners. Contra, who after several coaching roles in his homeland, led Getafe to safety after taking over for a brief spell in March 2014. As a player, Contra played for AC Milan and Atletico Madrid while also earning over 70 international caps for Romania.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Siwarak Tedsungnoen	20/04/1984
2	DF	Theerathon Bunmathan	06/02/1990
3	DF	Kipthom Bunsan	29/11/1993
4	MF	Wanchalerm Yingyong	12/08/1993
5	DF	Andres Tunez	15/03/1987
7	MF	Ko Seul-ki	21/04/1986
8	MF	Suchao Nutnum	17/05/1983
10	MF	Jakkaphan Kaewprom	24/05/1988
13	DF	Narubadin Weerawatnodom	12/07/1994
14	DF	Chitipat Thanklang	11/08/1991
15	MF	Surat Sukha	27/07/1982
16	DF	Koravit Namwiset	02/08/1986
17	MF	Anawin Jujeen	13/03/1987
18	FW	Sittichok Kannoo	09/08/1996
19	MF	Naruphol Ar Romsawa	16/09/1988
21	MF	Prakit Deeprom	07/01/1988
22	FW	Gilberto Macena	01/04/1984
23	MF	Santirad Wiang-in	12/10/1989
24	DF	Nukoolkit Krutyai	23/09/1992
25	DF	Suree Sukha	27/07/1982
26	GK	Yotsapon Teangdar	06/04/1992
28	MF	Chaowat Veerachat	23/06/1996
29	MF	Nattawut Sombatyotha	01/05/1996
38	GK	Niwat Buttakoon	27/09/1986
39	GK	Sornchai Suklom	12/01/1995
40	FW	Diogo	26/05/1987

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Cheng Yuelei	28/10/1987
3	DF	Yu Yang	06/08/1989
4	DF	Jin Yangyang	03/02/1993
5	DF	Zhang Yaokun	07/04/1981
6	MF	Wang Song	12/10/1983
7	FW	Jiang Ning	01/09/1986
8	MF	Park Jong-woo	10/03/1989
9	FW	Abderrazzaq Hamedallah	17/12/1990
10	MF	Michel	29/07/1988
11	MF	Jiang Zhipeng	06/03/1989
12	GK	Zhang Shichang	07/10/1989
13	MF	Ye Chugui	08/09/1994
14	DF	Li Jianhua	12/02/1982
15	DF	Jang Hyun-soo	28/09/1991
16	DF	Feng Zhuoyi	18/06/1989
18	FW	Zhang Yuan	08/12/1989
20	MF	Tang Miao	16/10/1990
21	FW	Chang Feiya	03/02/1993
23	MF	Lu Lin	03/02/1985
24	FW	Men Yang	20/02/1991
27	GK	Liu Diansuo	26/06/1990
28	DF	Pei Chensong	30/07/1993
29	FW	Zhang Shuo	17/09/1983
30	DF	Fu Yunlong	18/03/1995
33	MF	Li Yan	19/07/1984
35	FW	Min Junlin	19/01/1994
41	DF	Zhang Ao	16/01/1991
42	DF	Zeng Chao	23/01/1993
43	DF	Chen Zepeng	18/05/1996
44	DF	Zhang Chenlong	27/04/1993

GROUP G

Brisbane Roar

Australia



Qualified as: A-League Premiership – Winner / Grand Final – Winner • **Founded:** 2005
Ground: Brisbane Stadium, Brisbane (52,500) / Robina Stadium, Robina (27,400)
A-League Grand Final (3): 2014, 2012, 2011
A-League Premiership (2): 2014, 2011
AFC Champions League: Group Stage 2012

Overview

Crowned A-League Premiers for the second time in April 2014, Brisbane Roar continued their domestic dominance with a third Grand Final victory a month later after beating eventual AFC Champions League winners Western Sydney Wanderers. One of the founding members of the A-League in 2005, the club originally known as Queensland Roar struggled in the early seasons before earning their maiden AFC Champions League appearance in 2012 after winning a dramatic 2011 Grand Final on penalties over Central Coast Mariners. Brisbane did fail to post a win on their continental debut, ending the group stage with three draws, before also losing in the 2013 play-offs after being edged out by Thailand’s Buriram United.

Key Players

Vastly experienced captain Matt McKay is a newly crowned AFC Asian Cup winner having scored once in four appearances as Australia won the continental championship on home soil at the start of 2015. Midfielder McKay returned to Brisbane Roar in August 2013 following spells with Rangers in Scotland, China’s Changchun Yatai and Korean club Busan I’Park. Brazilian striker Henrique is in his sixth year with Brisbane and the former America Mineiro and Feyenoord forward remains a key component having scored in both Grand Finals triumphs in 2011 and 2014. A graduate from the Brisbane academy, midfielder Luke Brattan shook off a spate of injury–hampered seasons and was named in the Professional Football Association A-League Team of the Season alongside team–mates Ivan Franjic, Matt Smith, Thomas Broich and Besart Berisha.

Coach: Frans Thijssen

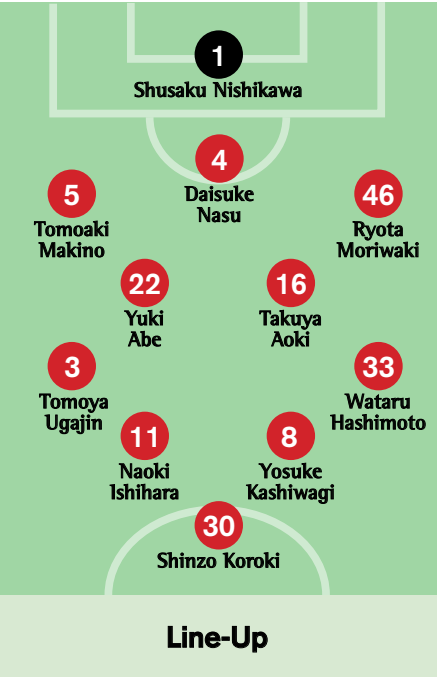
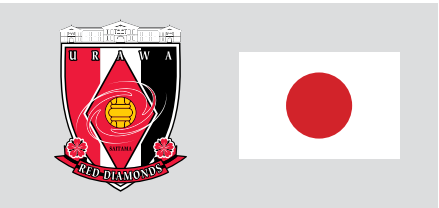
Former Netherlands international midfielder Frans Thijssen replaced Mike Mulvey at Brisbane Roar initially on an interim basis in November 2014 following spells in his homeland, Sweden, the United Arab Emirates and Qatar. As a player, Thijssen began his career in the Netherlands before moving to England and winning the UEFA Cup and being named Footballer of the Year in 1981. He retired in 1991 following further spells in England, Canada and the Netherlands.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Michael Theo	11/02/1981
3	DF	Shane Stefanutto	12/01/1980
4	MF	Adam Sarota	28/12/1988
5	DF	Corey Brown	07/01/1994
6	MF	George Lambadaridis	23/04/1992
8	MF	Steven Lustica	12/04/1991
9	FW	Andrija Kaluderovic	05/07/1987
10	FW	Henrique	09/05/1985
13	DF	Jade North	07/01/1982
14	DF	Daniel Bowles	19/10/1991
15	DF	James Donachie	14/05/1993
16	MF	Devante Clut	16/10/1995
17	MF	Matt McKay	11/01/1983
18	MF	Luke Brattan	08/03/1990
19	DF	Jack Hingert	26/09/1990
20	FW	Kofi Danning	02/03/1991
21	GK	Jamie Young	25/08/1985
22	MF	Thomas Broich	29/01/1981
23	MF	Dmitri Petratos	10/11/1992
26	DF	Lachlan Jackson	12/03/1995
27	MF	Ben Litfin	25/03/1995
28	FW	Brandon Borrello	25/07/1995
29	MF	Patrick Theodore	16/05/1996
33	DF	Luke Devere	05/11/1989
34	FW	Shannon Brady	21/06/1996
35	MF	Mitchell Hore	05/04/1996
36	GK	Fraser Chalmers	09/03/1995
37	GK	Denver Crickmore	13/11/1996
38	FW	Nicholas D’agostino	25/02/1998

GROUP G

Urawa Red Diamonds

Japan



Qualified as: J.League – Runner-up • **Founded:** 1950 • **Ground:** Saitama Stadium 2002, Saitama City (60,000)
J.League (1): 2006; Runner-up 2007, 2005, 2004
Emperor’s Cup (2): 2006, 2005
AFC Champions League (1): 2007; Semi-Finals 2008; Group Stage 2013
Asian Cup Winners’ Cup (2): 1993, 1992

Overview

Former champions Urawa Red Diamonds return to the AFC Champions League after narrowly missing out on only their second J.League crown. Edged out by treble winners Gamba Osaka by a single point, Urawa lost on the final day when a victory would have claimed the title. The Reds were the first Japanese side to win the revamped AFC Champions League and first to land the continental title since Jubilo Iwata won the Asian Club Championship in 1999 after beating Iran’s Sepahan in the 2007 final. They did return to the semi-finals in 2008 and lost to eventual champions Gamba before suffering a group stage exit on their last appearance in 2013.

Key Players

Goalkeeper Shusaku Nishikawa played a big part in Urawa Red Diamonds’ backline solidity in 2014 and the Japan international was named in the J.League’s Best XI. Captain Yuki Abe, along with Nishikawa, made the most appearances for Urawa in 2014 after the former Japan midfielder helped the Reds win the AFC Champions League in 2007 by scoring a goal in the second leg of the final against Sepahan. Abe is in his second spell with Urawa having arrived from hometown club JEF United Chiba after a two–year interlude in England with Leicester City before returning to Saitama Stadium in 2012 and adds experience and versatility to the squad. Shinzo Koroki was Urawa’s top scorer last season with 12 goals in the J.League having won three consecutive domestic titles and the Emperor’s Cup on two occasions with former club Kashima Antlers.

Coach: Mihailo Petrovic

Mihailo Petrovic was appointed as Urawa Red Diamonds coach in December 2011 after a successful five–year spell with J.League rivals Sanfrecce Hiroshima and the former Yugoslavia international helped transform the side from relegation contenders to title challengers in his first season. The 57–year–old had arrived at Sanfrecce following spells in Slovenia and Austria and Petrovic secured the J2 title in 2008 and a fourth–place finish in the top flight the following year.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Shusaku Nishikawa	18/06/1986
2	DF	Kenichi Kaga	30/09/1983
3	MF	Tomoya Ugajin	23/03/1988
4	DF	Daisuke Nasu	10/10/1981
5	DF	Tomoaki Makino	11/05/1987
7	MF	Tsukasa Umesaki	23/02/1987
8	MF	Yosuke Kashiwagi	15/12/1987
11	FW	Naoki Ishihara	14/08/1984
13	MF	Keita Suzuki	08/07/1981
14	DF	Tadaaki Hirakawa	01/05/1979
15	GK	Koki Otani	08/04/1989
16	MF	Tatsuya Aoki	16/09/1989
17	DF	Mitsuru Nagata	06/04/1983
18	MF	Shuto Kojima	30/07/1992
19	FW	Yuki Muto	07/11/1988
20	FW	Tadanari Lee	19/12/1985
21	FW	Zlatan Ljubijankic	15/12/1983
22	MF	Yuki Abe	06/09/1981
23	GK	Nao Iwadate	17/08/1988
24	MF	Takahiro Sekine	19/04/1995
25	MF	Shota Saito	07/12/1996
27	DF	Rikiya Motegi	27/09/1996
30	FW	Shinzo Koroki	31/07/1986
31	FW	Toshiyuki Takagi	25/05/1991
33	DF	Wataru Hashimoto	14/09/1986
36	DF	Takuya Okamoto	18/06/1992
46	DF	Ryota Moriwaki	06/04/1986

GROUP G

Suwon Samsung

Korea Republic



Qualified as: K-League Classic – Runner-up • **Founded:** 1995
Ground: Suwon World Cup Stadium, Suwon (43,288)
K-League (4): 2008, 2004, 1999, 1998
FA Cup (3): 2010, 2009, 2002
AFC Champions League: Semi-Finals 2011; Quarter-Finals 2010; Round of 16 2009; Group Stage 2013, 2005
Asian Club Championship (2): 2002, 2001
Asian Cup Winners' Cup: Runner-up 1998 • **Asian Super Cup (2):** 2002, 2001

Overview

Formed in 1995, Suwon Samsung won back-to-back league titles in 1998 and 1999, swiftly followed by consecutive continental crowns as they claimed the last two editions of the Asian Club Championship in 2001 and 2002, as well as securing the Asian Super Cup in both years. Success at home has continued since then with domestic championships in 2004 and 2008, but further Asian titles have proved more elusive after failing to progress beyond the group stage in their last appearance in 2013. Suwon came close to adding a third continental honour in 2011 when the K-League side were edged out in the semi-finals of the AFC Champions League 2-1 on aggregate by eventual winners Al Sadd from Qatar.

Key Players

K-League Classic top scorer Santos scored 14 goals last year as Suwon Samsung claimed second place in the K-League Classic table and the Brazilian was one of only two foreign players to be selected in the 2014 Best XI. He previously played in Korea's top-flight with Jeju United before a spell in China with Wuhan Zall. Left-back Hong Chul was also named in the Best XI having won the AFC Champions League in 2010 with Seongnam FC. The highly-rated 24-year-old full-back has also made a handful of appearances for Korea Republic. DPR Korea international Jong Tae-se was Suwon's second highest scorer in the league last year. The former VFL Bochum and FC Koln striker helped Japan's Kawasaki Frontale reach the quarter-finals of the AFC Champions League in both 2007 and 2009.

Coach: Seo Jung-won

Former winger Seo Jung-won won the Asian Club Championship with Suwon Samsung in both 2001 and 2002 before the former club captain was promoted from assistant coach after Yoon Sung-hyo departed following the 2012 campaign. Former international Seo represented Korea Republic at the FIFA World Cup on two occasions before retiring in 2007 having also spent time playing in France and Austria. After switching to coaching, Seo worked as an assistant within the Korea set-up before joining Suwon in 2012.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Jung Sung-ryong	04/01/1985
2	DF	Choi Jae-soo	02/05/1983
3	DF	Yang Sang-min	24/02/1984
4	DF	Oh Beom-seok	29/07/1984
5	DF	Jo Sung-jin	14/12/1990
6	MF	Kim Eun-sun	30/03/1988
7	MF	Lee Sang-ho	09/05/1987
9	MF	Oh Jang-eun	24/07/1985
10	FW	Santos	25/12/1985
11	FW	Leo	12/04/1989
12	MF	Ko Cha-won	30/04/1986
13	MF	Seo Jung-jin	06/09/1989
14	FW	Jong Tae-se	02/03/1984
15	DF	Ku Ja-ryong	06/04/1992
16	MF	Cho Ji-hun	29/05/1990
18	FW	Kaio	06/07/1987
19	MF	Jang Hyun-soo	01/01/1993
20	MF	Baek Ji-hoon	28/02/1985
21	GK	No Dong-geon	04/10/1991
22	MF	Kwon Chang-hoon	30/06/1994
23	MF	Jeon Hyun-ouk	16/03/1992
24	MF	Koh Min-seong	20/11/1995
25	MF	Han Sung-gyu	27/01/1993
26	MF	Yeom Ki-hun	30/03/1983
30	DF	Sin Se-gye	16/09/1990
31	GK	Lee Sang-wook	09/03/1990
32	FW	Bang Chang-jun	15/04/1994
33	DF	Hong Chul	17/09/1990
34	DF	Yeon Jei-min	28/05/1993
39	DF	Min Sang-gi	27/08/1991

GROUP G

Beijing Guoan

China



Qualified as: Chinese Super League – Runner-up via play-offs • **Founded:** 1992
Ground: Workers' Stadium, Beijing (61,000)
Chinese Super League (1): 2009
FA Cup (3): 2003, 1997, 1996
AFC Champions League: Round of 16 2013, 2010; Group Stage 2014, 2012, 2009, 2008

Overview

Runners-up to Guangzhou Evergrande in the Chinese Super League in 2014, Beijing Guoan booked their place in the group stage of the AFC Champions League for the seventh time in eight years after comfortably beating Thailand's Bangkok Glass 3-0 in the play-offs in February. Beijing have been one of the most consistent teams in the Chinese Super League in recent years, finishing in the top-three in eight of the last nine seasons. They also reached the Round of 16 in the AFC Champions League in 2010 and 2013 but were eliminated in the group stage in 2014 after losing to Korea Republic's FC Seoul on the final Matchday.

Key Players

Montenegro international Dejan Damjanovic netted seven times in the 2013 AFC Champions League to help FC Seoul to a runners-up finish, but the striker left the K-League Classic club shortly after to sign for Jiangsu Sainty in December 2013. The following summer Damjanovic joined Beijing Guoan and his goals led the capital city club to a runners-up finish in the Chinese Super League. Argentinian playmaker Pablo Batalla is the creative hub for Beijing and the former Bursaspor midfielder was behind only Damjanovic on the top scorers list for the club in 2014. Midfielder Zheng Chengdong was the only member of Beijing's squad selected for the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 and the winger impressed as he started every game in Australia as China reached the quarter-finals. Chengdong has previously played in Italy, Portugal and Germany before signing for Beijing in 2013.

Coach: Gregorio Manzano

Former RCD Mallorca coach Gregorio Manzano took Beijing Guoan to a runners-up finish in the Chinese Super League in his first full season with the club in 2014 and the Spaniard was named the 2014 Chinese Football Association Coach of the Year. Manzano, who led Mallorca to the 2003 Copa del Rey title in the first of his three stints with the Palma-based side, previously worked with numerous La Liga clubs including Atletico Madrid, Sevilla, and Malaga before joining Beijing at the start of 2014.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Zhao Shi	16/03/1993
2	DF	Li Yunqiu	03/10/1990
3	DF	Li Lei	30/05/1992
4	DF	Zhou Ting	05/02/1979
6	MF	Zhang Xiaobin	14/02/1985
8	MF	Piao Cheng	21/08/1989
9	FW	Tan Tiancheng	15/05/1991
10	FW	Dejan Demjanovic	27/07/1981
11	MF	Song Boxuan	16/09/1989
12	GK	Hou Sen	30/06/1989
13	DF	Xu Yunlong	17/02/1979
14	DF	Jin Pengxiang	25/01/1990
15	GK	Shi Xiaotian	06/03/1990
16	MF	Ha Dae-sung	02/03/1985
17	MF	Pablo Batalla	16/01/1984
18	DF	Lang Zheng	22/07/1986
19	FW	Yu Dabao	18/04/1988
20	DF	Zhang Xinxin	19/10/1983
21	FW	Erton Fejzullahu	09/04/1988
22	GK	Yang Zhi	15/01/1983
23	MF	Chen Zhizhao	14/03/1988
24	MF	Li Hanbo	26/01/1991
26	MF	Wang Hao	18/02/1989
27	MF	Du Mingyang	20/01/1993
28	FW	Zhang Chengdong	09/02/1989
29	MF	Shao Jiayi	10/04/1980
30	DF	Lei Tenglong	17/01/1991
31	DF	Zhao Heijing	11/05/1985
34	MF	Ba Dun	16/09/1995
35	MF	Li Tixiang	01/09/1989

GROUP H

Guangzhou Evergrande

China



Qualified as: Chinese Super League - Champion • **Founded:** 1954
Ground: Tianhe Sports Center Stadium, Guangzhou (60,000)
Chinese Super League (4): 2014, 2013, 2012, 2011
FA Cup (1): 2012; Runner-up 2013
AFC Champions League (1): 2013; Quarter-Finals 2014, 2012

Overview

Guangzhou Evergrande made history in 2013 as they became the first Chinese side to be crowned Asian champions since Liaoning won the Asian Club Championship in 1990 after defeating Korea Republic's FC Seoul on away goals in the AFC Champions League final following a 3-3 draw on aggregate. Guangzhou, though, were eliminated in the 2014 quarter-finals by eventual champions Western Sydney Wanderers from Australia on away goals. But Guangzhou return in 2015 having won a fourth consecutive Chinese Super League title in 2014 under Marcello Lippi having only returned to the top-flight in 2011. FIFA World Cup-winning coach Lippi, though, stepped down at the end of 2014 and was replaced by former Italy captain Fabio Cannavaro.

Key Players

National team icon and club captain Zheng Zhi continues to be the heart of Guangzhou Evergrande having been named AFC Player of the Year in 2013 as the club won the AFC Champions League title. Having led Guangzhou to their fourth consecutive league title in 2014, Zheng also captained China as they reached the quarter-finals of the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015. Brazilian striker Elkeson continues to re-write records in the Chinese Super League and his 28 goals in 28 league games in 2014 was an all-time high for the domestic championship having netted 24 in the previous season. Compatriot Alan joined from Red Bull Salzburg ahead of the 2015 following the departures of Italian duo Alessandro Diamanti and Alberto Gilardino. Alan netted over 60 goals in his last two seasons with the Austrian champions.

Coach: Fabio Cannavaro

Former Ballon d'Or winner Fabio Cannavaro replaced Italian compatriot Marcelo Lippi as coach of Guangzhou Evergrande last November for his first role in management. The former defender enjoyed a glittering playing career that included successful spells at Italian Serie A sides Inter Milan and Juventus and in Spain with Real Madrid, while Cannavaro captained Italy to victory at the 2006 FIFA World Cup under Lippi.

GROUP H

Western Sydney Wanderers

Australia



Qualified as: A-League Premiership – Runner-up • **Founded:** 2012
Ground: Parramatta Stadium, Parramatta (21,500)
A-League Premiership (1): 2013; Runner-up 2014
A-League Grand Final: Runner-up 2013, 2014
AFC Champions League (1): 2014

Overview

Western Sydney Wanderers defied expectation on their AFC Champions League debut in 2014 as the A-League side overcame strong opposition to become the first Australian club to win a continental club title just two years after being founded. Winners of the A-League Premiership and Grand Final runners-up in their debut season in 2013, Tony Popovic's side defeated former champions Ulsan Hyundai and Guangzhou Evergrande and 2013 runners-up FC Seoul during their run to the final before edging out Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal 1-0 on aggregate thanks to Tomi Juric's first leg strike. Western Sydney also reached the A-League Grand Final in 2014 but lost 2-1 to Brisbane Roar.

Key Players

Matthew Spiranovic was a rock at the heart of the Western Sydney Wanderers defence that claimed the 2014 AFC Champions League title, and the centre-back continued his peerless form for Australia in January as his partnership with Trent Sainsbury was a big part of Australia's run to the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 title. Another member of the triumphant Socceroos side was Tomi Juric, the striker who made James Troisi's winner in the final against Korea Republic, and was himself on target in the final of the 2014 AFC Champions League as his goal was the difference in the 1-0 aggregate victory over Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal. Signed from Sanfrece Hiroshima at the start of 2015, Japanese playmaker Yojiro Takahagi is a two-time J.League winner and was named in the J.League's Best XI in 2012. Takahagi joined Hiroshima in 2003 and made over 200 appearances for the J.League side.

Coach: Tony Popovic

Tony Popovic was named the 2014 AFC Coach of the Year after masterminding Western Sydney Wanderers' AFC Champions League success. The former Australia international defender, who played for clubs in Japan, England and Qatar during his career, served as an assistant coach at Sydney FC and Crystal Palace before taking over the newly-formed Western Sydney in 2012. Popovic also led the side to the Premiership crown in their inaugural season in the A-League in 2012/13.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Dong Chunyu	25/03/1991
2	MF	Liao Lisheng	29/04/1993
3	DF	Mei Fang	14/11/1989
4	MF	Zhang Jiaqi	09/12/1991
5	DF	Zhang Linpeng	09/05/1989
6	DF	Feng Xiaoting	22/10/1985
7	FW	Alan	10/07/1989
9	FW	Elkeson	13/07/1989
10	MF	Zheng Zhi	20/08/1980
11	FW	Ricardo Goulart	16/09/1989
14	MF	Feng Renliang	08/01/1989
16	MF	Huang Bowen	13/07/1987
17	MF	Liu Jian	20/01/1985
18	FW	Dong Xuesheng	22/05/1989
19	GK	Zeng Cheng	08/01/1987
20	MF	Yu Hanchao	25/02/1987
21	MF	Zhao Xuri	03/12/1985
22	GK	Li Shuai	18/08/1982
23	MF	Yang Xin	25/01/1994
25	MF	Zou Zheng	07/02/1988
26	FW	Wang Jingbin	09/05/1995
27	MF	Zheng Long	15/04/1988
28	DF	Kim Young-gwon	27/02/1990
29	FW	Gao Lin	14/02/1986
30	DF	Hu Bao	05/01/1998
31	DF	Luo Jiacheng	05/01/1995
32	MF	Ju Feng	01/11/1995
33	DF	Rong Hao	07/04/1987
34	FW	Wang Junhui	18/05/1995
35	DF	Li Xuepeng	18/09/1988

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Ante Covic	13/06/1975
2	DF	Shannon Cole	04/08/1984
3	DF	Yusuke Tanaka	03/02/1986
4	DF	Nikolai Topor-Stanley	11/03/1985
5	DF	Brendan Hamill	18/09/1992
6	DF	Antony Golec	29/05/1990
7	FW	Labinot Haliti	26/10/1985
9	FW	Tomi Juric	22/07/1991
10	MF	Yojiro Takahagi	02/08/1986
11	FW	Brendon Santalab	09/09/1982
12	FW	Nikita Rukavytsya	22/06/1987
13	DF	Matthew Spiranovic	27/06/1988
14	FW	Kerem Bulut	03/02/1992
15	MF	Yianni Perkatis	08/03/1994
16	MF	Jaushua Sotirio	11/10/1995
17	MF	Romeo Castelen	30/05/1983
18	MF	Iacopo La Rocca	17/02/1984
19	FW	Mark Bridge	07/11/1985
20	GK	Dean Bouzanis	02/10/1990
23	MF	Jason Trifiro	03/06/1988
25	DF	Sam Gallaway	16/03/1992
30	GK	Thomas Heward-Belle	11/03/1997
31	MF	Alusine Fofanah	21/11/1997
32	MF	Daniel Alessi	26/08/1997
33	MF	Nicholas Kalmar	15/10/1987
35	MF	Kearyn Baccus	05/09/1991
36	MF	Liam Youlley	20/02/1997
37	MF	Jonathan Aspropotamitis	07/06/1996
38	FW	Steve Kuzmanovski	04/01/1997
39	DF	Shayne D'Cunha	01/04/1996



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历久弥新



GROUP H

Kashima Antlers

Japan



Qualified as: J.League – Third Place • Founded: 1991 • Ground: Kashima Soccer Stadium, Kashima City (37,638)
J.League (7): 2009, 2008, 2007, 2001, 2000, 1998, 1996
Emperor's Cup (4): 2010, 2007, 2000, 1997
AFC Champions League: Quarter-Finals 2008; Round of 16 2011, 2010, 2009; Group Stage 2003

Overview

Kashima Antlers are by far the J.League's most successful club with seven championships to their name, while they have only failed to progress beyond the group stage of the AFC Champions League once in five appearances and that was on their debut appearance in the revamped continental tournament in 2003. Kashima reached the quarter-finals in 2008, losing to eventual finalists Adelaide United, before advancing to the Round of 16 on their last three appearances in 2009, 2010 and 2011. Kashima qualified for the 2015 edition having finished third in the J.League in 2014, although the Ibaraki club narrowly missed out on an eighth J.League title after finishing just three points behind champions Gamba Osaka after losing to Sagan Tosu on the final day.

Key Players

Midfielder Gaku Shibasaki has been a fixture for Kashima Antlers in the last three seasons, but enjoyed a breakout year in 2014 and was named in the J.League's Best XI. That earned Shibasaki a place in the Japan squad at the AFC Asian Cup Australia 2015 where he made two appearances and scored in the quarter-final defeat by the United Arab Emirates. Veteran Takeshi Aoki is a one-club man who has been with Kashima since 2001 and the defensive midfielder brings much-needed experience and leadership to a youthful side. Prior to the 2015 campaign, Aoki has already racked up nearly 30 AFC Champions League appearances for Kashima having played in 2008, 2009, 2010 and 2011. Amongst Kashima's biggest goal-threats will be Brazilian Caio after the forward was named the 2014 J.League Rookie of the Year and netted eight league goals.

Coach: Toninho Cerezo

Having coached Kashima Antlers to a pair of J.League titles including the Japanese treble in 2000, Toninho Cerezo returned for a second spell as coach of the Ibaraki club in 2013. And the former Brazil international midfielder, who enjoyed much success as a player with Italian sides Roma and Sampdoria, led Kashima to a third place finish in 2014. Cerezo has also coached in Saudi Arabia with Al Hilal and in the United Arab Emirates with Al Shabab, Al Arabi and Al Ain.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Akihiro Sato	30/08/1986
3	DF	Gen Shoji	11/12/1992
4	DF	Kazuya Yamamura	02/12/1989
5	MF	Takeshi Aoki	28/09/1982
7	MF	Caio	19/04/1994
8	MF	Shoma Doi	21/05/1992
10	MF	Masashi Motoyama	20/06/1979
11	FW	Davi	10/03/1984
13	MF	Atsutaka Nakamura	13/09/1990
14	DF	Hwang Seok-ho	27/06/1989
15	FW	Hiroyuki Takasaki	17/03/1986
16	DF	Shuto Yamamoto	01/06/1985
17	DF	Ryuga Suzuki	28/02/1994
18	FW	Shuhei Akasaki	01/09/1991
19	FW	Yuta Toyokawa	09/09/1994
20	MF	Gaku Shibasaki	28/05/1992
21	GK	Hitoshi Sogahata	02/08/1979
22	DF	Daigo Nishi	28/08/1987
23	DF	Naomichi Ueda	24/10/1994
24	DF	Yukitoshi Ito	03/09/1993
25	MF	Yasushi Endo	07/04/1988
26	MF	Kazune Kubota	01/01/1997
27	MF	Takahide Umebachi	08/06/1992
29	GK	Shinichiro Kawamata	23/07/1989
30	MF	Hisashi Ohashi	01/12/1996
31	GK	Yuto Koizumi	14/09/1995
32	MF	Taro Sugimoto	12/02/1996
33	MF	Mu Kanazaki	16/02/1989
34	FW	Yuma Suzuki	26/04/1996
40	MF	Mitsuo Ogasawara	05/04/1979

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GROUP H FC Seoul

Korea Republic



Qualified as: K-League Classic – Third via play-offs • **Founded:** 1983 •
Ground: Seoul World Cup Stadium, Seoul (66,080)
K-League (5): 2012, 2010, 2000, 1990, 1985
FA Cup (1): 1998
AFC Champions League: Runner-up 2013; Semi-Finals 2014; Quarter-Finals 2011, 2009
Asian Club Championship: Runner-up 2002

Overview

After losing to Guangzhou Evergrande on away goals in the 2013 AFC Champions League Final, FC Seoul went all the way to the semi-finals in 2014 after tight wins over Japan's Kawasaki Frontale and Pohang Steelers having won their group only to lose 2-0 on aggregate to eventual winners Western Sydney Wanderers of Australia. FC Seoul eventually finished third in the K League Classic and lost the Korean FA Cup on penalties to Seongnam FC, but a crushing 7-0 victory over Vietnam's Hanoi T&T in the AFC Champions League play-offs in February secured a spot in the group stage of the continental competition for a the third year in a row.

Key Players

Midfielder Yun Il-lok only turns 23 in March but the 2015 AFC Champions League will be his third continental campaign with FC Seoul. Yun has already scored seven times in the AFC Champions League and also led his club in the scoring charts in 2014. An ever-present for FC Seoul in the K-League Classic last year, Spanish centre-back Osmar Barba clocked up more appearances and minutes on the field than any of his team-mates. Barba was on the books of Racing Santander in Spain before joining Buriram United in 2012, and after a successful two-year spell in Thailand, signed for FC Seoul ahead of the 2014 season. Long-serving midfielder Koh Myong-jin has participated in all four of FC Seoul's previous AFC Champions League campaigns. A two-time K-League and League Cup winner with FC Seoul, Koh was also named in the 2014 K-League Best XI.

Coach: Choi Yong-soo

Appointed as caretaker coach in April 2011 following the resignation of Hwangbo Kwan, Choi Yong-soo landed the K-League title in his first full season in charge a year later and was named the K-League Coach of the Year. A hard working and prolific striker during his playing days, Choi played for Korea Republic at the 1998 and 2002 FIFA World Cup. He began his playing career at Anyang Cheetahs in 1994 and had spells at three Japanese clubs before he retired as an FC Seoul player in 2006.

No.	Pos.	Name	Date of Birth
1	GK	Kim Yong-dae	11/10/1979
3	DF	Lee Woong-hee	18/07/1988
4	DF	Osmar Barba	05/06/1988
5	DF	Cha Du-ri	25/07/1980
6	DF	Kim Jin-kyu	16/02/1985
7	DF	Kim Chi-woo	11/11/1983
8	MF	Lee Seok-hyun	13/06/1990
10	FW	Everton Santos	14/10/1986
11	MF	Mauricio Molina	30/04/1980
13	MF	Go Yo-han	10/03/1988
14	FW	Park Hee-seong	07/04/1990
15	MF	Choi Jung-han	03/06/1989
16	MF	Jung Seung-yong	25/03/1991
17	MF	Yun Il-lok	07/03/1992
18	FW	Kim Hyun-sung	27/09/1989
19	FW	Yun Ju-tae	22/06/1990
21	DF	Sim Sang-min	21/05/1993
22	MF	Koh Myong-jin	09/01/1988
23	MF	Kim Min-hyeok	16/08/1992
24	DF	Hwang Hyun-soo	22/07/1995
26	DF	Kim Nam-chun	19/04/1989
27	MF	Ko Kwang-min	21/09/1988
28	DF	Kim Dong-woo	02/05/1988
29	MF	Lee Sang-hyeob	01/01/1990
31	GK	Yu Sang-hun	25/05/1989
34	MF	Park Yong-woo	10/09/1993
36	FW	Jung Jo-gook	23/04/1984
38	GK	Yang Han-been	30/08/1991
40	FW	Shim Je-hyeok	05/03/1995

Roll of Honour

Early Years

Inaugurated in 1967, the Asian Club Championship was dominated by clubs from Israel with Hapoel Tel Aviv claiming the inaugural title after beating Malaysia's Selangor in the final in Bangkok. Maccabi Tel Aviv then won twice in three years either side of Iran's Taj – now known as Esteghlal – who beat Hapoel Tel Aviv. The competition then disappeared from the calendar after the 1971 edition.

Competition Reborn

The tournament returned in 1985 and Daewoo Royals of the newly formed Korean K-League – inaugurated in 1983 – became the first winners from East Asia after beating Saudi Arabia's Al Ahli. The region dominated the competition in the late 1980's with pre-J.League sides Furukawa and Yomiuri prevailing before Qatar's Al Sadd broke the run in 1989.

West returns, Farmers rise

Clubs from Iran and Saudi Arabia came to the fore in the early 1990s as Tehran's Esteghlal beat defending champions Liaoning of China in July 1991, before losing their crown to Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal. Pas of Iran beat Saudi side Al Shabab 1993, before Thai Farmers Bank claimed successive titles.

Professionalism brings success

The K-League dominated the mid-1990's as Ilhwa Chunma lifted the trophy in 1995 before Pohang Steelers won back-to-back titles in 1997 and 1998. Boosted by the foundation of professional leagues in Japan and China, the East won six of the last seven editions of the Asian Club Championship as Japan's Jubilo Iwata reached three straight finals, while Saudi Arabia's Al Hilal flew the flag for the West in 2000 after Jubilo's 1999 success. Korea Republic's Suwon Samsung Bluewings won the last two editions of the Asian Club Championship in 2001 and 2001 after beating Jubilo and Anyang Cheetahs.

Champions League era

The Asian Club Championship was discontinued in 2002 and merged with the Asian Cup Winners' Cup to form the AFC Champions League. Al Ain from the United Arab Emirates were victorious in the first final, which was delayed until October 2003 due to SARS and the Iraq War. The event followed a single year format from 2004, with Saudi Arabia's Al Ittihad winning back-to-back titles in 2004 and 2005 before the East rose again as Korea's Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors and Japanese duo Urawa Red Diamonds and Gamba Osaka lifted the prestigious trophy.

New format

In keeping with a rise in standards across the region, the AFC Champions League ushered in a new dynamic format in 2009 with only clubs and leagues professionally run as commercial entities eligible. Prize money was also increased and the competition expanded from 28 to 32 teams, while a one-leg Round of 16 and one-leg final were also introduced. The showpiece final was held in Tokyo in 2009 and 2010, with K-League clubs Pohang Steelers and then Seongnam Ilhwa Chunma victorious.

Growth continues

Jeonbuk earned the right to host the 2011 final, but missed out on keeping the trophy in Korean hands as Qatar's Al Sadd became the first qualifiers to win the continental title. Korea were not to be denied a year later, though, claiming a third AFC Champions League crown in four years as Ulsan Hyundai completed an unbeaten campaign with a 3-0 win over Saudi Arabia's Al Ahli. Korea were also represented in the 2013 final, but FC Seoul were edged out on away goals by Guangzhou Evergrande, who became the first Chinese side in 23 years to lift the title. The 2014 edition of the tournament was expanded with more teams eligible to participate in the play-off rounds, with Western Sydney Wanderers eventually becoming the first Australian side to crowned continental champions after beating Al Hilal 1-0 on aggregate.



2014 Winners - Western Sydney Wanderers



2013 Winners - Guangzhou Evergrande

AFC Champions League

Year	Winners	Score	Runners-up
2014	Western Sydney Wanderers	1-0 agg	Al Hilal
2013	Guangzhou Evergrande	3-3 agg	FC Seoul
2012	Ulsan Hyundai	3-0	Al Ahli
2011	Al Sadd	2-2*	Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors
2010	Seongnam Ilhwa Chunma	3-1	Zobahan
2009	Pohang Steelers	2-1	Al Ittihad
2008	Gamba Osaka	5-0 agg	Adelaide United
2007	Urawa Red Diamonds	3-1 agg	Sepahan
2006	Jeonbuk Hyundai Motors	3-2 agg	Al Karama
2005	Al Ittihad	5-3 agg	Al Ain
2004	Al Ittihad	6-3 agg	Seongnam Ilhwa
2002-03	Al Ain	2-1 agg	BEC Tero Sasana

Asian Club Championship

Year	Winners	Score	Runners-up
2001-02	Suwon Bluewings	0-0*	Anyang Cheetahs
2000-01	Suwon Bluewings	1-0	Jubilo Iwata
1999-00	Al Hilal	3-2	Jubilo Iwata
1998-99	Jubilo Iwata	2-1	Esteghlal
1997-98	Pohang Steelers	0-0*	Dalian Wanda
1996-97	Pohang Steelers	2-1	Ilhwa Chunma
1995	Ilhwa Chunma	1-0	Al Nassr
1994-95	Thai Farmers Bank	1-0	Al Arabi
1993-94	Thai Farmers Bank	2-1	Oman Club
1992-93	Pas	1-0	Al Shabab
1991	Al Hilal	1-1*	Esteghlal
1990-91	Esteghlal	2-1	Liaoning
1989-90	Liaoning	3-2 agg	Nissan
1988-89	Al Saad	3-3 agg	Al Rasheed
1987	Yomiuri	w-o	Al Hilal
1986	Furukawa	g-s	Al Hilal
1985-86	Daewoo Royals	3-1	Al Ahli
1972-84	No competition		
1971	Maccabi Tel Aviv	w-o	Al Shorta
1970	Taj	2-1	Hapoel Tel Aviv
1969	Maccabi Tel Aviv	1-0	Yangzee
1967	Hapoel Tel Aviv	2-1	Selangor

* won on penalties; agg – aggregate (away goals win if level); g-s – group-stage format; w-o – walkover

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